CHESS HANDOUTS

SERGEY V. POPOV

MASTER

26 lessons · 156 puzzles from master games · Solutions on page 53

Name: _____ **Club / group:** _____

Colour Key

Strategy
What each advantage is worth

Openings
Time and development

Attack
King safety and the attack

Endgame
Converting into a win

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3	Bishop vs Knight	p. 5 · puzzles p. 6
4	The Exchange	p. 7 · puzzles p. 8
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6	Time: Worth a Pawn?	p. 11 · puzzles p. 12
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Examples and puzzles from published master games (game scores are factual records); positions checked with Stockfish. Chess pieces: Noto Sans Symbols 2 (SIL Open Font License).

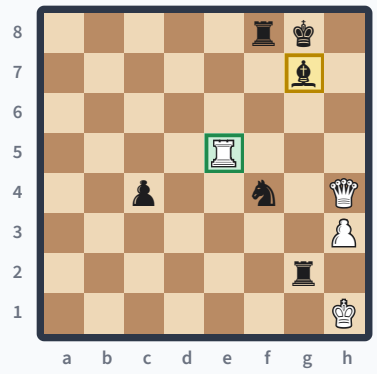
THE SCALE OF VALUES

Queen 9.75 · Rook 5 · Bishop 3.25 · Knight 3.25 · pawn 1

Lesson 1 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

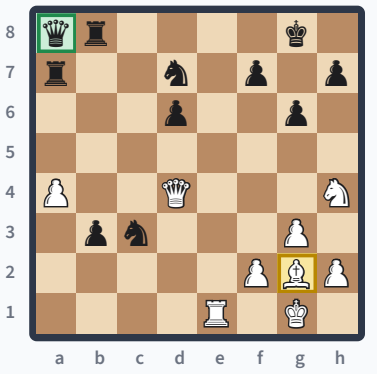


`35...Bxe5 36.Qe1 Re2`

- **Win rate with an extra pawn: 43%/37%/20%**
- The table (Kaufman) is a guide, not a law: a piece is worth what it can do.
- Count the whole sequence, not just the first capture.
- Bronstein v Hebden, Lloyds Bank op 1989: **35...Bxe5!** (winning 5 points).

2. Carlsen–Calzetta

COUNT IT

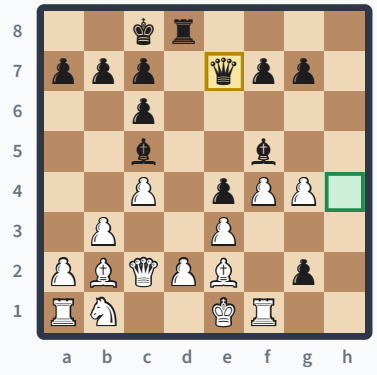


`28.Bxa8 Rc7 29.Qxd6`

- White can win material.
- **28.Bxa8!** 28...Rc7 29.Qxd6, winning 10 points.
- Carlsen v Calzetta, Claude Pecaut Mem 2003

3. Larsen–Spassky

COUNT IT

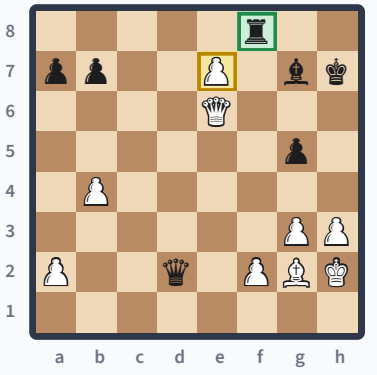


`16...Qh4+ 17.Kd1 gxf1=R+`

- Black can win material.
- **16...Qh4+!** 17.Kd1 gxf1=R+, and mate follows.
- Larsen v Spassky, Belgrade URS-World 1970

4. Petrosian–Gurgenidze

COUNT IT



`31.exf8=Q Bxf8 32.Qf7+`

- White can win material.
- **31.exf8=Q!** 31...Bxf8 32.Qf7+, and mate follows.
- Petrosian v Gurgenidze, URS-chT 1975

Using the Scale

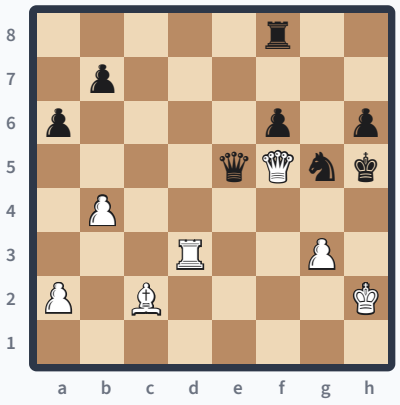
1. Before every capture, add up what you give and what you get, including the next two or three moves.
2. Two minor pieces usually beat a Rook and pawn in the middlegame; the Rook catches up in the endgame.
3. The values change with the position: count activity and King safety too.

PUZZLES: THE SCALE OF VALUES

Six positions from master games

Lesson 1 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

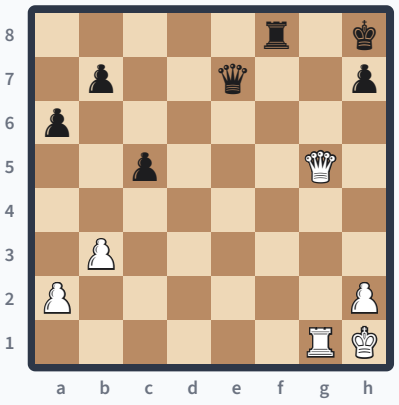
1 White to move. Win material!



Anand v Short
Dortmund 1997

Answer:

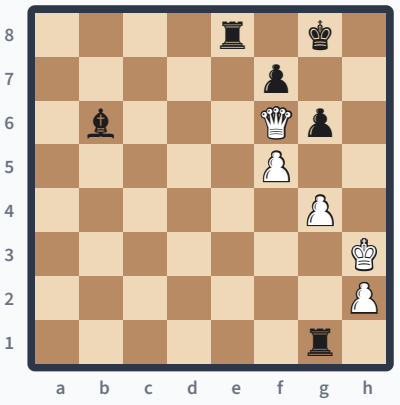
2 Black to move. Win material!



Krivoshey v Andersson
Bundesliga 2003-4

Answer:

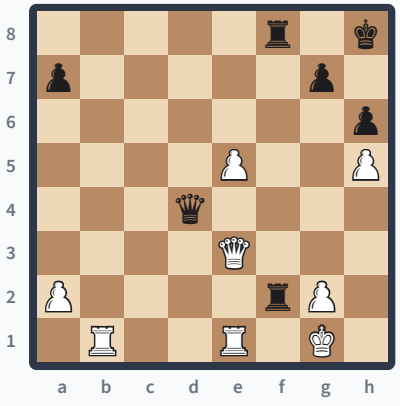
3 Black to move. Win material!



Aronian v Ivanchuk
4th M-Tel Masters 2008

Answer:

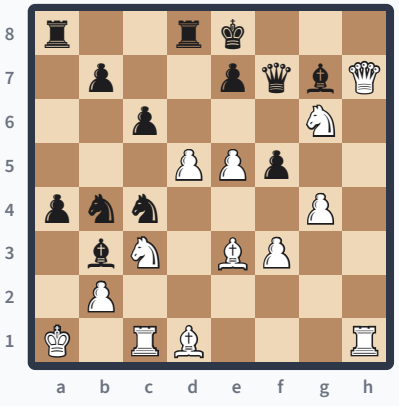
4 Black to move. Win material!



Carlsen v Hole
Classics IMA 2001

Answer:

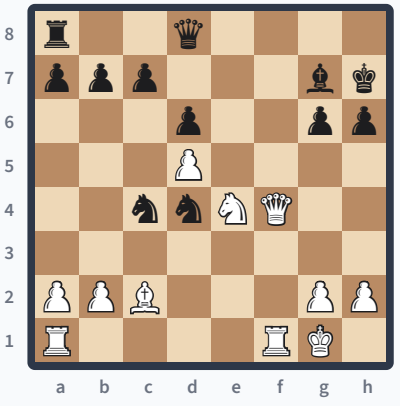
5 White to move. Win material!



Carlsen v Li
Qatar Masters Open 2015

Answer:

6 Black to move. Win material!



Thomason v Fischer
USA-chJ 1955

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

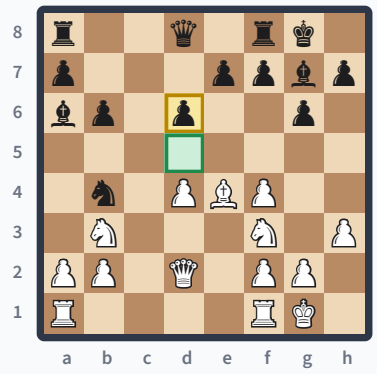
THE BISHOP PAIR

Worth about half a pawn

Lesson 2 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

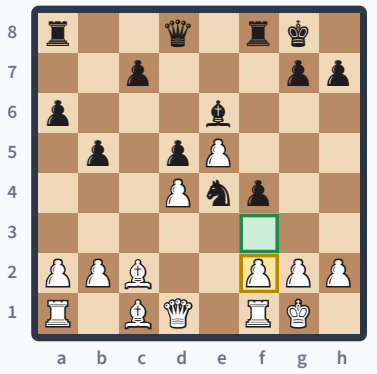


`15...d5 16.Bxg6 fxg6`

- **Win rate with the Bishop pair: 34%/42%/24%**
- Two Bishops cover both colours: together they are worth more than the sum of their parts.
- Kaufman: about **half a pawn**, more in open positions.
- Michel v Alekhine, Semmering 1926: **15...d5!** (winning 1 point).

2. Znosko Borovsky–Euwe

TWO BISHOPS

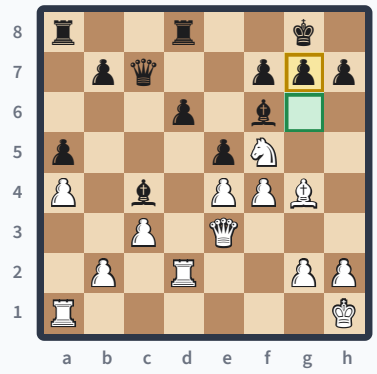


`16.f3 Ng5 17.h4`

- White has the two Bishops.
- **16.f3!** 16...Ng5 17.h4: White is clearly better (engine +1.8).
- Znosko Borovsky v Euwe, Zaanstreek 1946

3. Horowitz–Geller

TWO BISHOPS

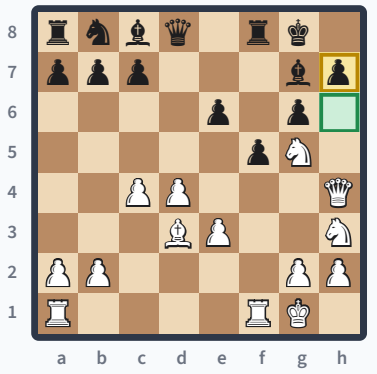


`25...g6 26.Ng3 d5`

- Black has the two Bishops.
- **25...g6!** 26.Ng3 d5: Black is clearly better (engine +2.0).
- Horowitz v Geller, USA-URS 1954

4. Morphy–Barnes

TWO BISHOPS



`14...h6 15.c5 Qe7`

- Black has the two Bishops.
- **14...h6!** 15.c5 Qe7: Black keeps an edge (engine +0.7).
- Morphy v Barnes, London m1 1858

Valuing the Pair

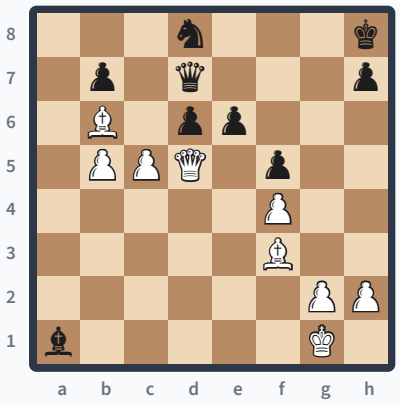
1. Open, fluid positions favour the pair; blocked pawn chains reduce it.
2. With the pair, avoid trading one Bishop cheaply: the bonus belongs to the pair, not to each Bishop.
3. Against the pair, keep the position closed and aim to trade one Bishop.

PUZZLES: THE BISHOP PAIR

Six positions from master games

Lesson 2 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

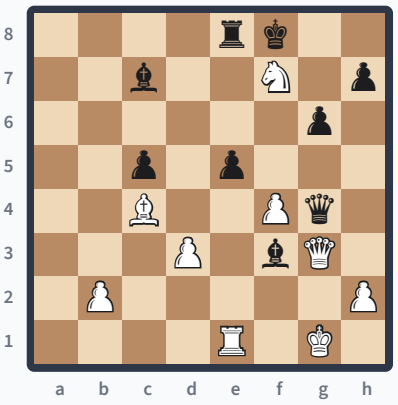
1 Find the best move for White!



Portisch v Pfleger
Manila 1974

Answer:

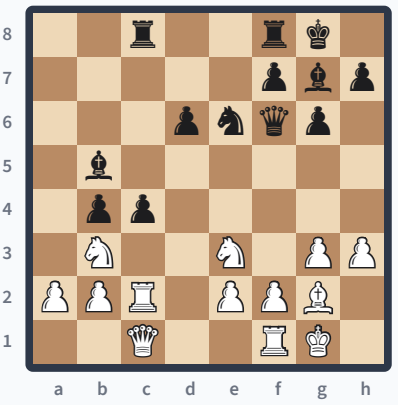
2 Find the best move for Black!



Carlsen v Svidler
FIDE Candidates 2013

Answer:

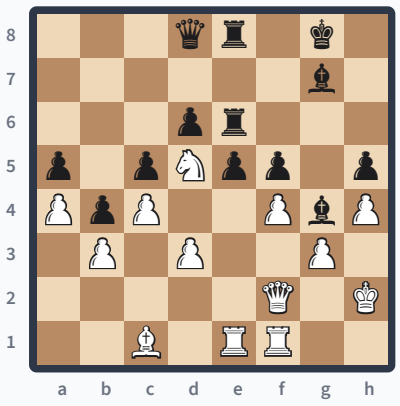
3 Find the best move for Black!



Khasin v Tal
URS-ch24 1957

Answer:

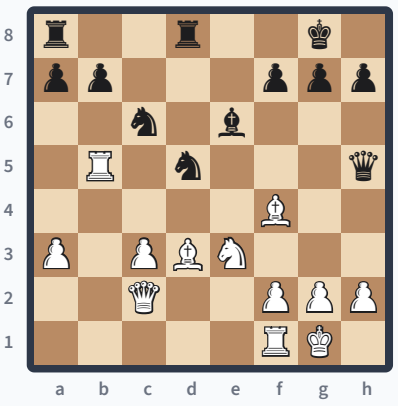
4 Find the best move for Black!



Karpov v Anand
Linares 1991

Answer:

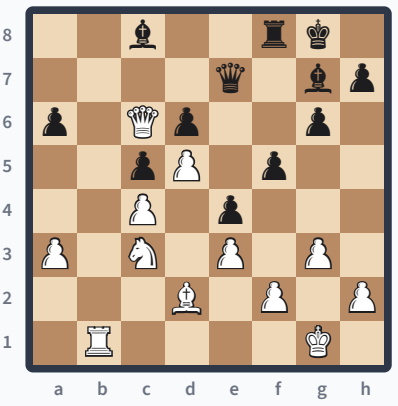
5 Find the best move for White!



Kortschnoj v Beliavsky
OHRA-A 1990

Answer:

6 Find the best move for Black!



Benko v Tal
Candidats Tournament 1959

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

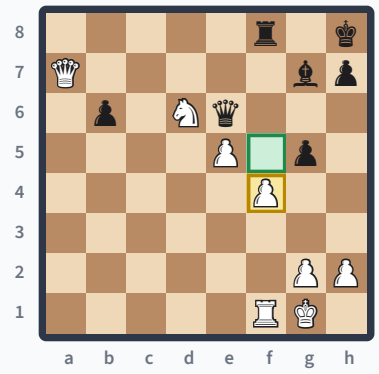
BISHOP VS KNIGHT

Equal on paper, rarely equal on the board

Lesson 3 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

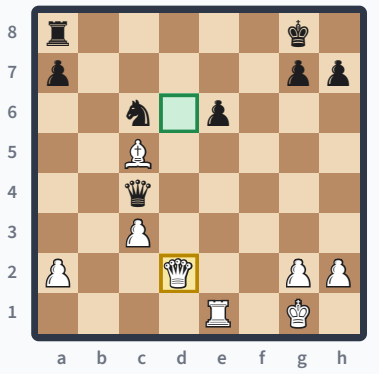


`36.f5 Qb3 37.f6`

- **Win rate with Bishop v Knight: 26%/49%/26%**
- Bishop: long range, one colour. Knight: short range, all squares.
- On average equal: the pawn structure decides.
- Vyzmanavin v Ivanchuk, URS Army-ch 1987: **36.f5!** White is winning (engine +4.7).

2. Reshevsky–Alekhine

MINOR PIECES

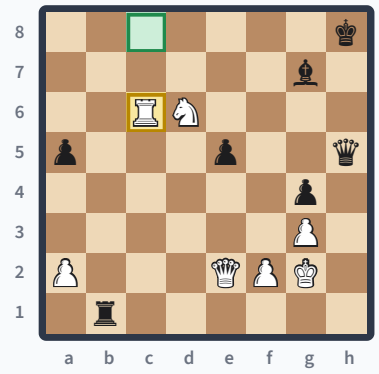


`29.Qd6 Rc8 30.Qxe6+`

- One Bishop against one Knight.
- **29.Qd6!** 29...Rc8 30.Qxe6+, winning 1 point.
- Reshevsky v Alekhine, AVRO 1938

3. Geller–Uhlmann

MINOR PIECES

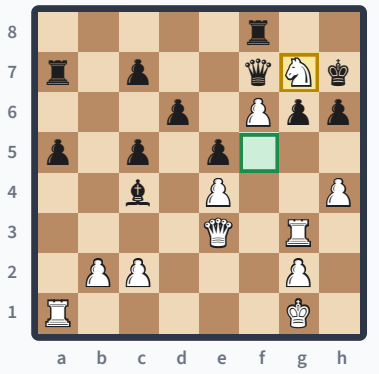


`44.Rc8+ Bf8 45.Qxe5+`

- One Bishop against one Knight.
- **44.Rc8+!** 44...Bf8 45.Qxe5+: White is clearly better (engine +1.7).
- Geller v Uhlmann, Stockholm Interzonal 1962

4. Morrison–Maroczy

MINOR PIECES



`32.Nf5 gxf5 33.Rg7+`

- One Bishop against one Knight.
- **32.Nf5!** 32...gxf5 33.Rg7+: White is clearly better (engine +1.9).
- Morrison v Maroczy, London 1922

Which Minor Piece?

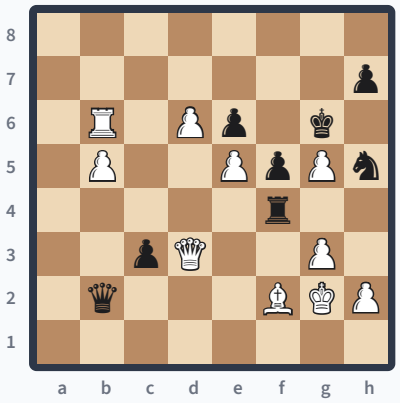
1. **Bishop:** open position, pawns on both wings, enemy pawns on its colour.
2. **Knight:** closed centre, outposts, all pawns on one wing, a "bad" enemy Bishop.
3. Fix the enemy pawns on the colour of your Bishop, or put your Knight where the Bishop can't reach it.

PUZZLES: BISHOP VS KNIGHT

Six positions from master games

Lesson 3 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

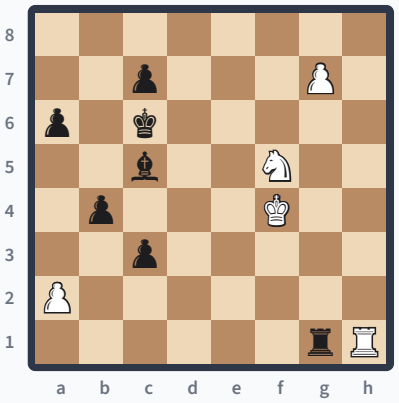
1 Find the best move for White!



Milov v Polgar
FIDE WCh KO 2001

Answer:

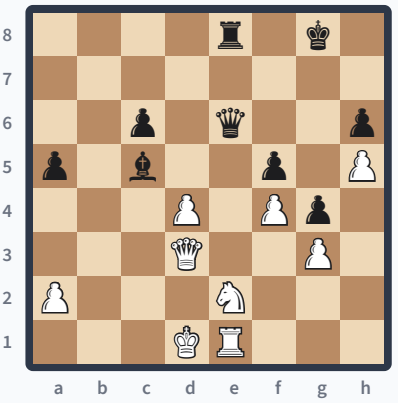
2 Find the best move for Black!



Pietzsch v Spassky
Capablanca mem 1962

Answer:

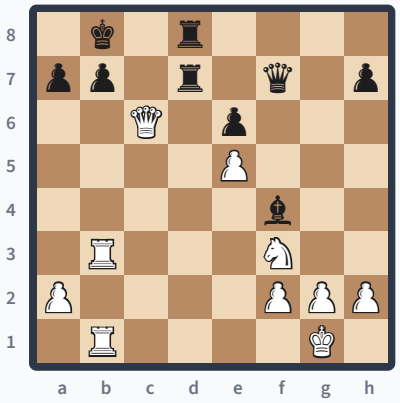
3 Find the best move for Black!



Adams v Topalov
Madrid 1996

Answer:

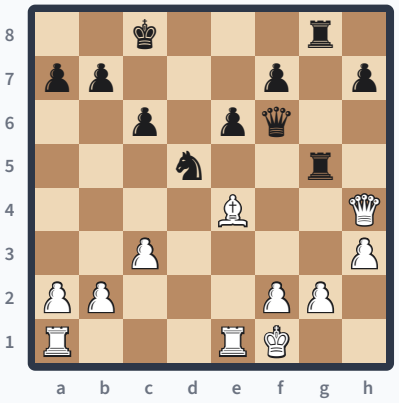
4 Find the best move for White!



Capablanca v Lasker
Lake Hopatcong 1926

Answer:

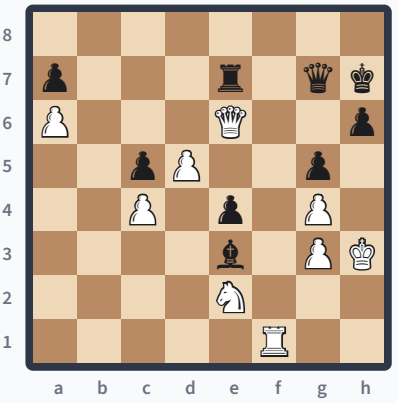
5 Find the best move for Black!



Soloviev v Petrosian
Moscow-ch 1950

Answer:

6 Find the best move for White!



Botvinnik v Shebarshin
Leningrad-5ch sf 1926

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

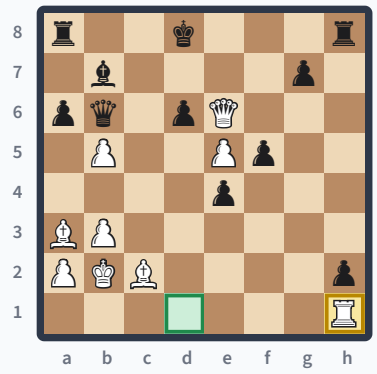
THE EXCHANGE

Rook against minor piece: what compensation costs

Lesson 4 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

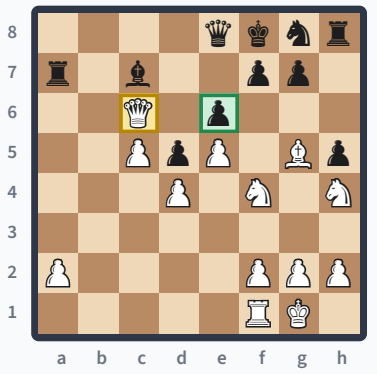


`29.Rd1 Ra7 30.Bxd6`

- **Win rate with the exchange up: 58%/22%/19%**
- About 2 pawns: it wins more often than an extra pawn.
- The other side needs a pawn plus activity.
- Pillsbury v Baird, Manhattan 1893: **29.Rd1!** (winning 1 point).

2. Geller–Karpov

EXCHANGE DOWN

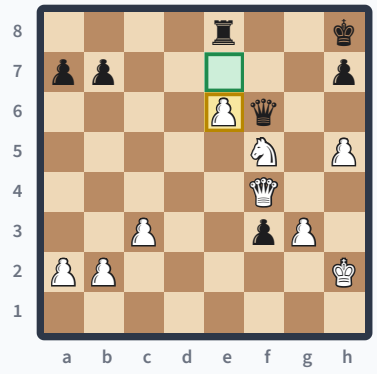


`25.Qxe6 Qxe6 26.Nxe6+`

- White is an exchange down.
- **25.Qxe6!** 25...Qxe6 26.Nxe6+: White is winning (engine +3.5).
- Geller v Karpov, URS-ch44 1976

3. Lasker–Chigorin

EXCHANGE DOWN

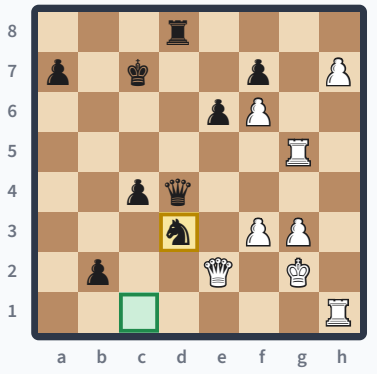


`32.e7 Kg8 33.Qxf3`

- White is an exchange down.
- **32.e7!** 32...Kg8 33.Qxf3, winning 1 point.
- Lasker v Chigorin, Brighton th-m 1903

4. Grischuk–Shirov

EXCHANGE DOWN



`35...Nc1 36.Qc2 Qd2+`

- Black is an exchange down.
- **35...Nc1!** 36.Qc2 Qd2+: Black keeps an edge (engine +0.7).
- Grischuk v Shirov, 18th European Teams 2011

Compensation for the Exchange

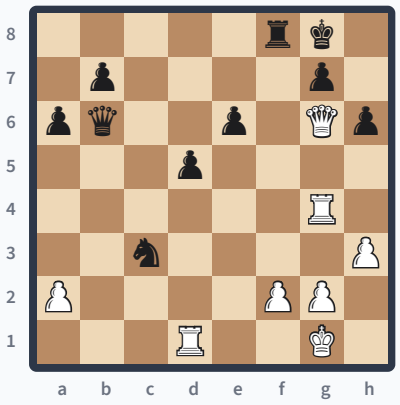
1. Look for: a strong outpost, a passed pawn, pressure on the King, or the enemy Rooks having no open files.
2. Keep the position closed and the Rooks inactive.
3. The side with the Rook wants open files and simplification.

PUZZLES: THE EXCHANGE

Six positions from master games

Lesson 4 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

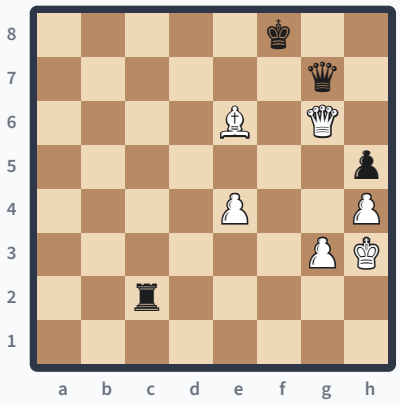
1 **Black is an exchange down. Find the best move!**



Alekhine v Spielmann
Semmering 1926

Answer:

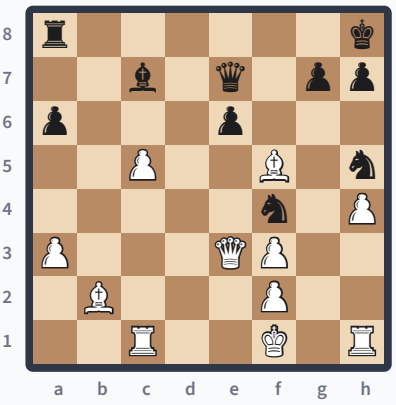
2 **White is an exchange down. Find the best move!**



Mamedyarov v Safarli
Vugar Gashimov Mem 2016

Answer:

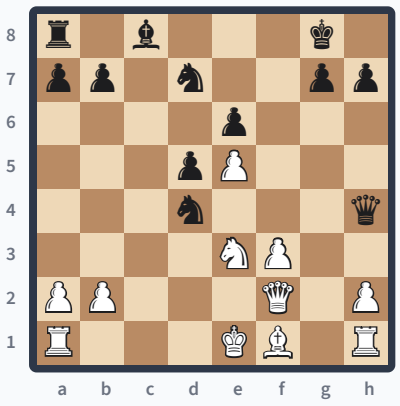
3 **Black is an exchange down. Find the best move!**



Anderssen v Harrwitz
Breslau m 1848

Answer:

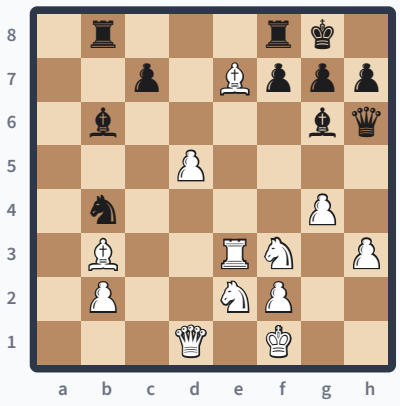
4 **Black is an exchange down. Find the best move!**



Harmonist v Tarrasch
DSB-05.Kongress 1887

Answer:

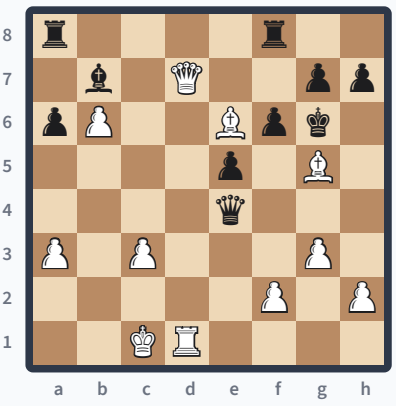
5 **White is an exchange down. Find the best move!**



Anand v Oll
EUCup final 14th 1999

Answer:

6 **White is an exchange down. Find the best move!**



Timman v Polgar
VAM Hoogeveen 3rd 1999

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

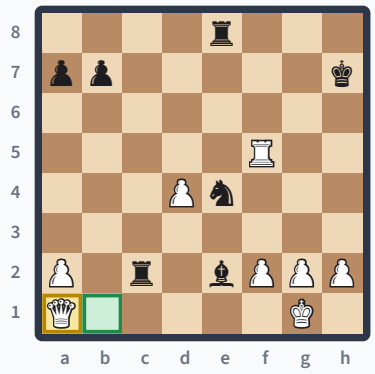
IMBALANCES

Queen v two Rooks · three minors v Queen · Rook v two minors

Lesson 5 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

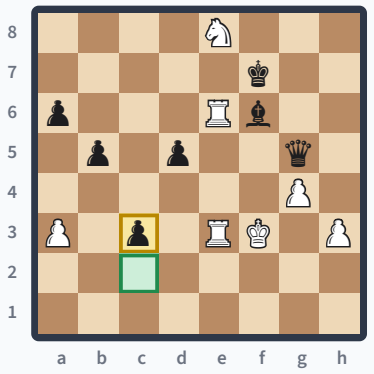


`33.Qb1 Rd2 34.Qxb7+`

- **Win rate with Queen v two Rooks: 38%/34%/28%**
- **Win rate with Rook v two minors: 23%/24%/53%**
- When material is different in kind, piece values only start the count. Coordination and King safety finish it.
- Tal v Meduna, Lvov 1981: **33.Qb1!** (winning 1 point).

2. Topalov–Glavina

IMBALANCE

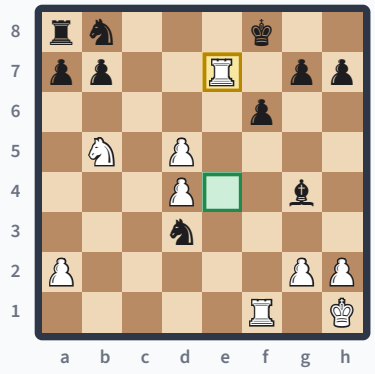


`50...c2 51.Rxf6+ Qxf6+`

- An unusual material balance.
- **50...c2!** 51.Rxf6+ Qxf6+: Black is winning (engine +3.8).
- Topalov v Glavina, St Cugat op 1992

3. Kramer–Euwe: 22.Re4!

IMBALANCE

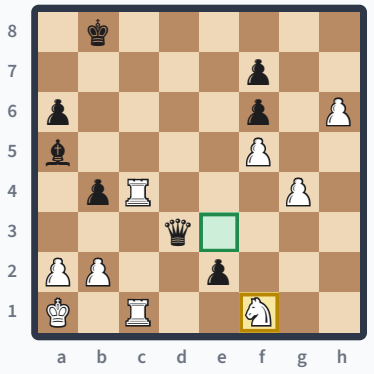


`22.Re4 Nb4 23.Nc7`

- An unusual material balance.
- **22.Re4!** 22...Nb4 23.Nc7: White is winning (engine +4.2).
- Kramer v Euwe, NLD m 1940

4. Shirov–Papaioannou

IMBALANCE



`41.Ne3 Ka7 42.h7`

- An unusual material balance.
- **41.Ne3!** 41...Ka7 42.h7: White is clearly better (engine +2.5).
- Shirov v Papaioannou, 17th TCh-Eur 2009

Handling Imbalances

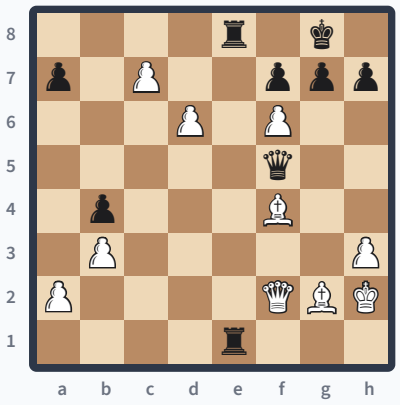
1. **Queen v two Rooks:** the Rooks win if they double; the Queen wins if she can fork or harass the King.
2. **Three minors v Queen:** the minors need to protect each other.
3. **Rook v two minors:** in the middlegame the minors are usually better.

PUZZLES: IMBALANCES

Six positions from master games

Lesson 5 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

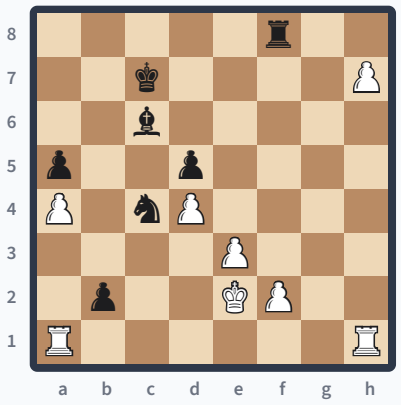
1 Find the best move for White!



Topalov v Aronian
Corus A 2006

Answer:

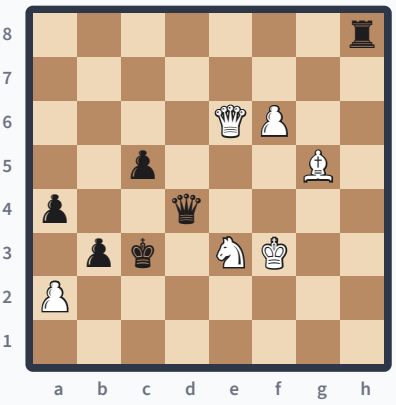
2 Find the best move for White!



Williams v Carlsen
GMA 2005

Answer:

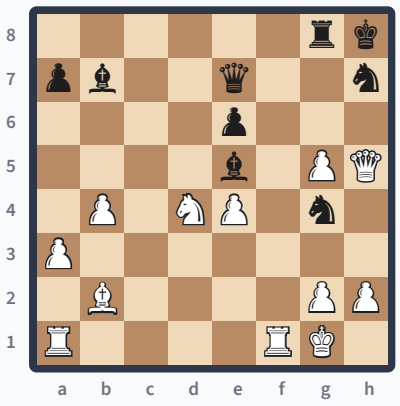
3 Find the best move for White!



Kasimdzhanov v Shirov
TCh-ESP Div Honor CECLUB 2009

Answer:

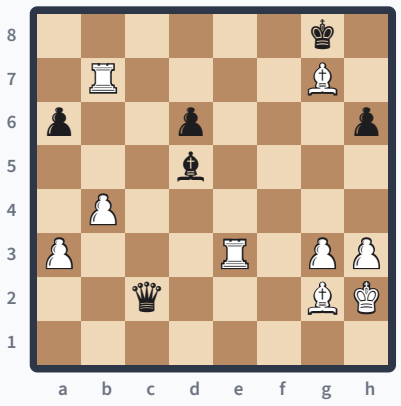
4 Find the best move for Black!



So v Sevian
ch-USA 2015

Answer:

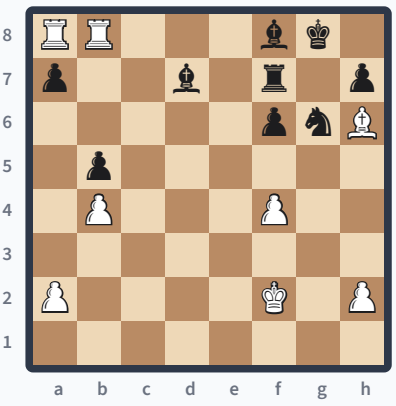
5 Find the best move for White!



Larsen v Miles
Bugojno 1984

Answer:

6 Find the best move for White!



Ponomariov v Topalov
Mtel Masters 2005

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

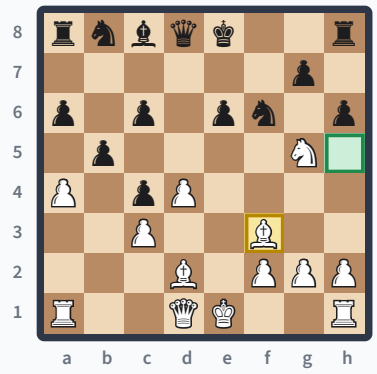
TIME

Time is worth a pawn only if you use it

Lesson 6 · Openings
Level 5 Openings

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

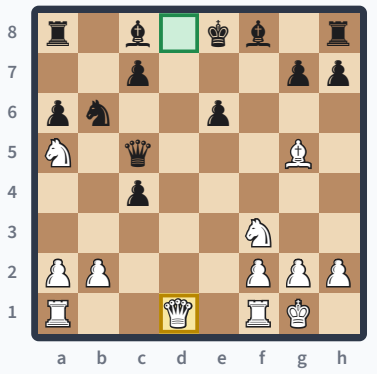


`14.Bh5+ Ke7 15.Nf7`

- **Win rate with two tempi ahead: 28%/45%/27%**
- Old rule: **three tempi ≈ one pawn**, but only if the time is used.
- Open the position at once (Lesson 14).
- Alekhine v Bogoljubow, World Championship 14th 1929: **14.Bh5+!** White is winning (engine +3.8).

2. Bronstein–Szabo

DEVELOPMENT LEAD

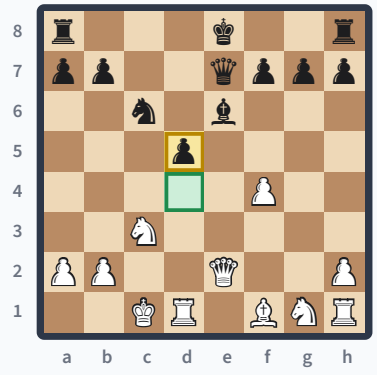


`15.Qd8+ Kf7 16.Be3`

- White is ahead in development.
- **15.Qd8+!** 15...Kf7 16.Be3: White is winning (engine +3.3).
- Bronstein v Szabo, Saltsjobaden Interzonal 1948

3. Furman–Bronstein

DEVELOPMENT LEAD

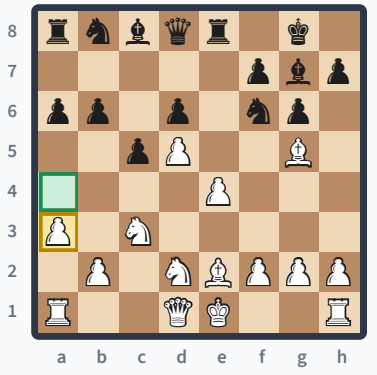


`15...d4 16.Nb5 a6`

- Black is ahead in development.
- **15...d4!** 16.Nb5 a6: Black is clearly better (engine +1.3).
- Furman v Bronstein, Moscow-Leningrad m 1967

4. Olafsson–Andersson

DEVELOPMENT LEAD



`12.a4 h6 13.Be3`

- White is ahead in development.
- **12.a4!** 12...h6 13.Be3: White is clearly better (engine +1.3).
- Olafsson v Andersson, Las Palmas 1975

Counting Time

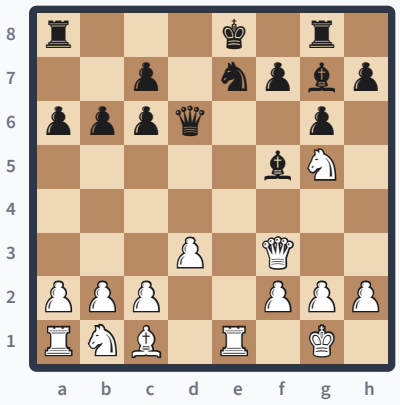
1. Count developed pieces and castling for both sides.
2. A development lead is worth most when the centre is open and the enemy King is still in it.
3. Time does not last: once the opponent catches up, the advantage is gone.

PUZZLES: TIME

Six positions from master games

Lesson 6 · Openings Puzzles
Level 5 Openings

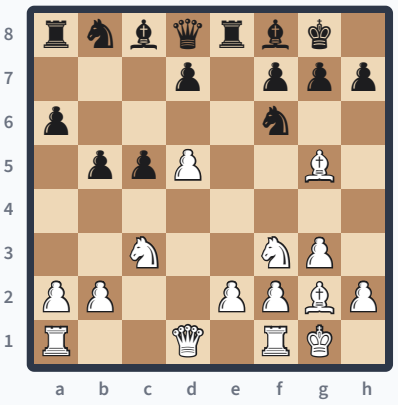
1 Find the best move for Black!



Gurevich v Bronstein
Hastings Challengers9192 1991

Answer:

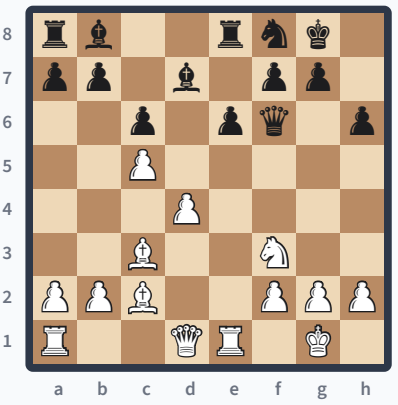
2 Find the best move for White!



Caruana v Garcia Palermo
68th ch-ITA 2008

Answer:

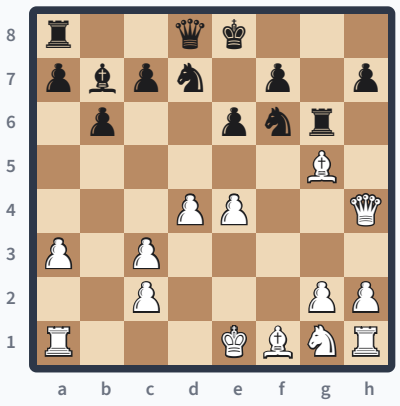
3 Find the best move for White!



Steinitz v Chigorin
World Championship 2nd 1889

Answer:

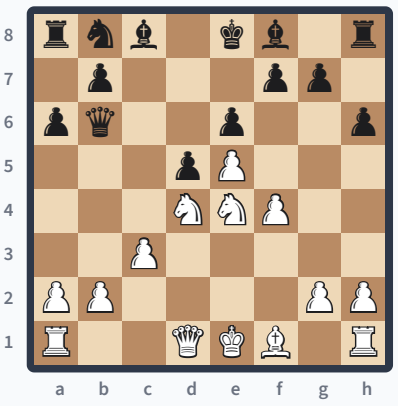
4 Find the best move for Black!



Bronstein v Hort
Moscow 1971

Answer:

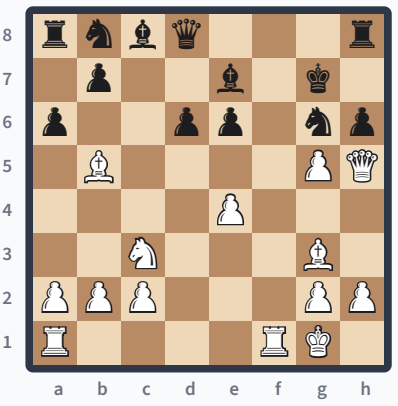
5 Find the best move for White!



Marshall v Steiner
Budapest 1928

Answer:

6 Find the best move for White!



Keres v Najdorf
Gothenburg Interzonal 1955

Answer:

Tip: count the tempi: who is ahead in development, and how long will it last?

Score: ____ / 6

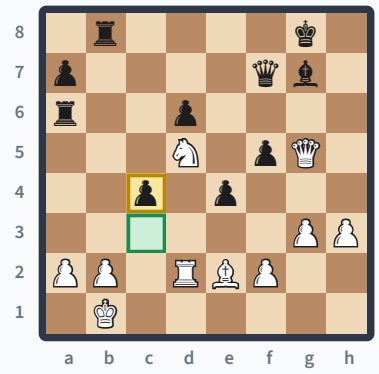
SPACE

More room to manoeuvre

Lesson 7 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

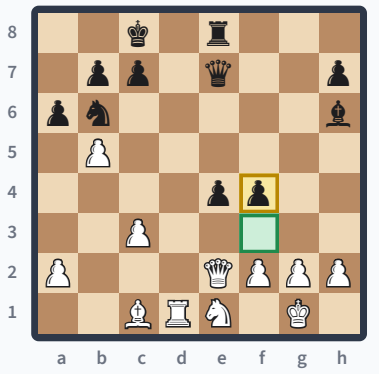


`33...c3 34.Nxc3 Rc6`

- **Win rate with more space: 48%/34%/18%**
- Pawns on the 5th rank give room and cramp the opponent.
- Slow: it matters most when there is no freeing break.
- Radjabov v Ding, 77th Tata Steel GpA 2015: **33...c3!** Black is clearly better (engine +2.5).

2. Jansa–Keres: 24...f3!

SPACE

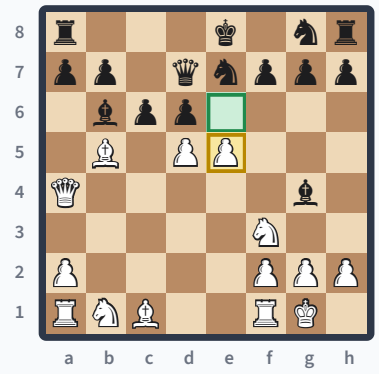


`24...f3 25.Qb2 Bxc1`

- Black has more space.
- **24...f3!** 25.Qb2 Bxc1: Black is clearly better (engine +2.6).
- Jansa v Keres, Luhacovice 1969

3. Anderssen–Hamel

SPACE

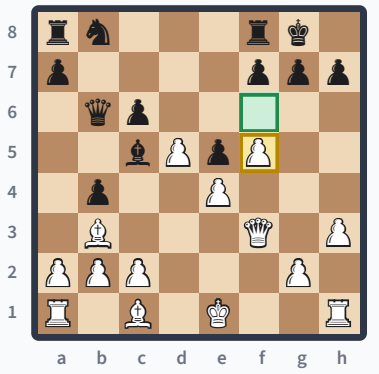


`13.e6 fxe6 14.Qxg4`

- White has more space.
- **13.e6!** 13...fxe6 14.Qxg4, winning 1 point.
- Anderssen v Hamel, Manchester 1857

4. Neumann–Anderssen

SPACE



`14.f6 g6 15.Bh6`

- White has more space.
- **14.f6!** 14...g6 15.Bh6: White is winning (engine +3.5).
- Neumann v Anderssen, Berlin m1 1866

Using Space

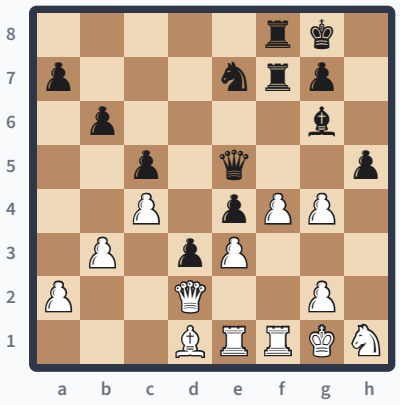
1. Keep pieces on: exchanges relieve the cramped side.
2. Use the extra room to switch pieces from wing to wing faster than the defender.
3. Watch the freeing breaks; space is only real while your pawns can't be undermined.

PUZZLES: SPACE

Six positions from master games

Lesson 7 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

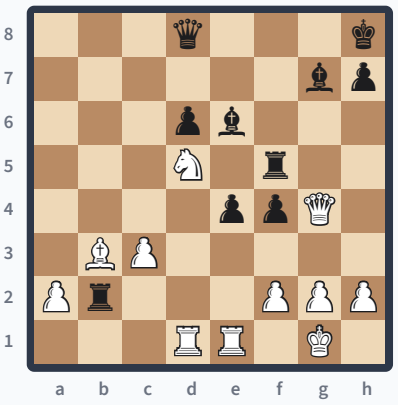
1 **Find the best move for Black!**



Lisitsin v Botvinnik
URS-ch13 1944

Answer:

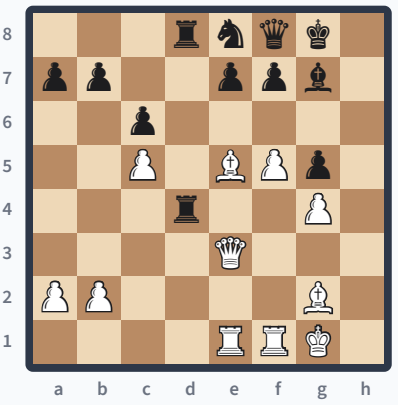
2 **Find the best move for Black!**



Fressinet v Gelfand
It 2003

Answer:

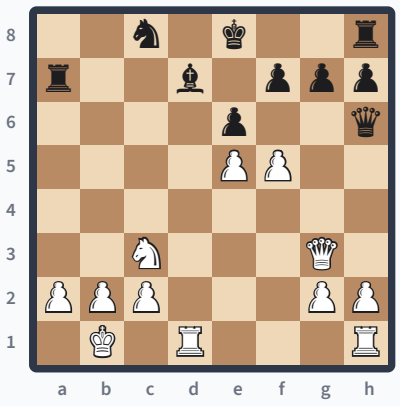
3 **Find the best move for White!**



Laznicka v Caruana
AAI GM 2011

Answer:

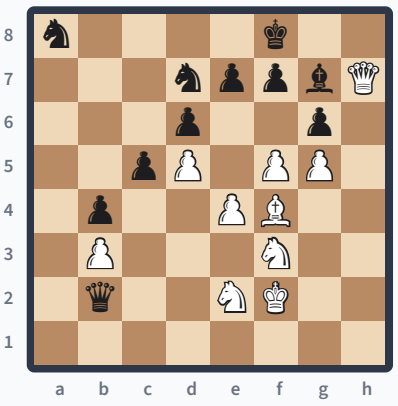
4 **Find the best move for White!**



Bonch Osmolovsky v Geller
URS-ch sf 1957

Answer:

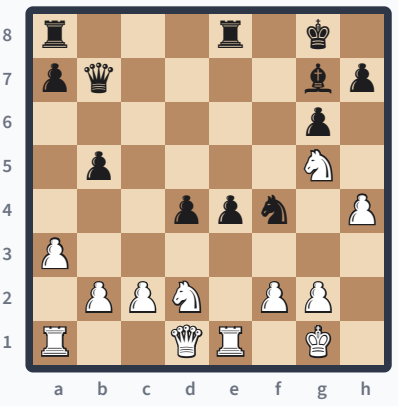
5 **Find the best move for White!**



Shirov v Nyback
36th Olympiad 2004

Answer:

6 **Find the best move for Black!**



Paulsen v Anderssen
Leipzig m 1876

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

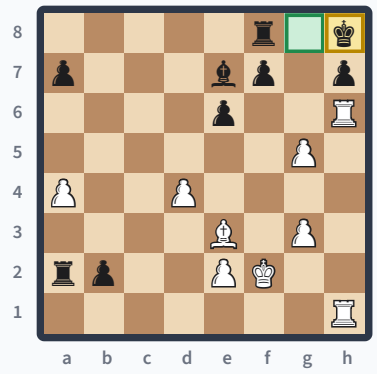
DOUBLED PAWNS

When are two pawns really one?

Lesson 8 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

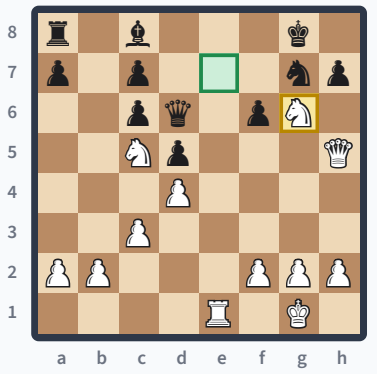


`39...Kg8 40.g4 Rxa4`

- **Win rate with doubled pawns: 26%/45%/29%**
- In the middlegame they control squares and open a file.
- In a pawn endgame the pair can be worth just **one** pawn.
- Johner v Nimzowitsch, Nordisk Skakforbund 1924: **39...Kg8!** (winning 1 point).

2. Corzo–Capablanca

DOUBLED PAWNS

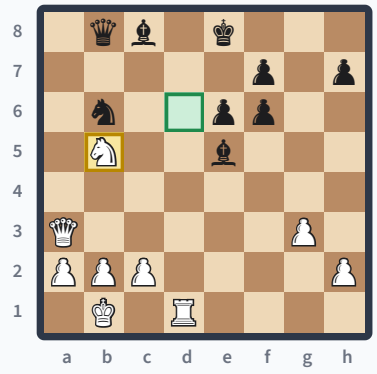


`20.Ne7+ Qxe7 21.Qxh7+`

- Doubled pawns on the board.
- **20.Ne7+!** 20...Qxe7 21.Qxh7+: White keeps an edge (engine +0.8).
- Corzo v Capablanca, Havana m 1901

3. Timman–Gelfand

DOUBLED PAWNS

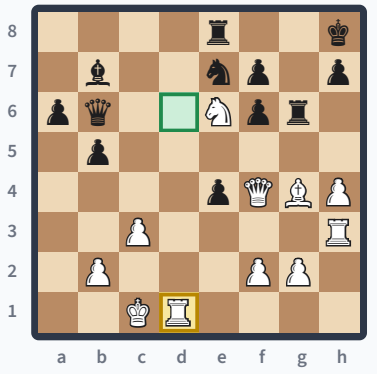


`23.Nd6+ Bxd6 24.Qxd6`

- Doubled pawns on the board.
- **23.Nd6+!** 23...Bxd6 24.Qxd6: White is clearly better (engine +1.0).
- Timman v Gelfand, Corus 2002

4. Kasparov–Kramnik

DOUBLED PAWNS



`26.Rd6 Qa7 27.Nc7`

- Doubled pawns on the board.
- **26.Rd6!** 26...Qa7 27.Nc7: White is clearly better (engine +2.1).
- Kasparov v Kramnik, Novgorod 1994

Doubled Pawns

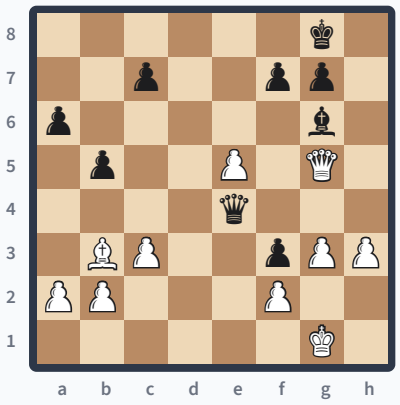
1. They are weakest when isolated as well, and in endgames.
2. They are fine when they control key central squares or open a file for your Rook.
3. Against them: trade pieces and head for the endgame.

PUZZLES: DOUBLED PAWNS

Six positions from master games

Lesson 8 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

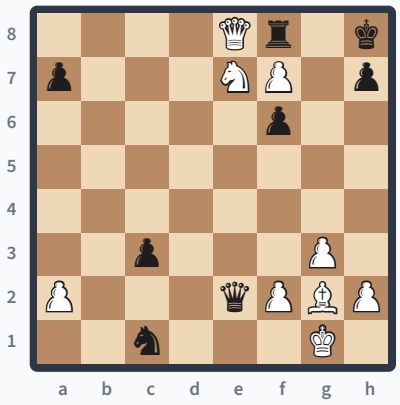
1 Find the best move for White!



Nakamura v Short
2nd London Chess Classic 2010

Answer:

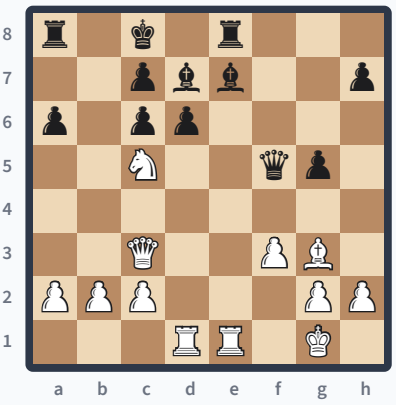
2 Find the best move for Black!



Rubinstein v Dus Chotimirsky
St Petersburg 1909

Answer:

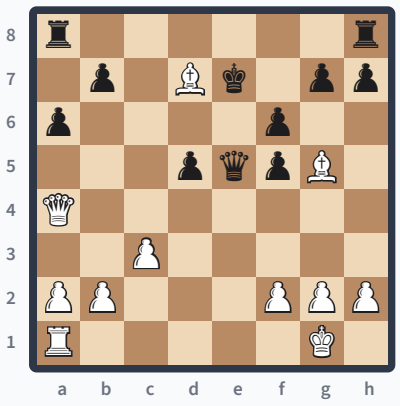
3 Find the best move for White!



Fleissig v Steinitz
Vienna 1873

Answer:

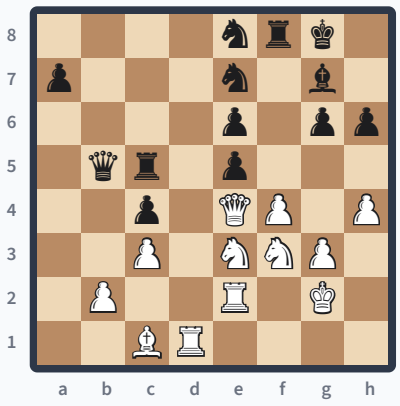
4 Find the best move for White!



Vachier Lagrave v Mchedlishvili
Bundesliga 2009-10

Answer:

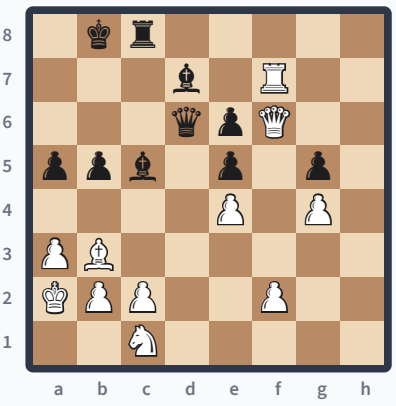
5 Find the best move for White!



Petrosian v Stahlberg
Candidats Tournament 1953

Answer:

6 Find the best move for White!



Anand v Sax
Reggio Emilia8889 1988

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

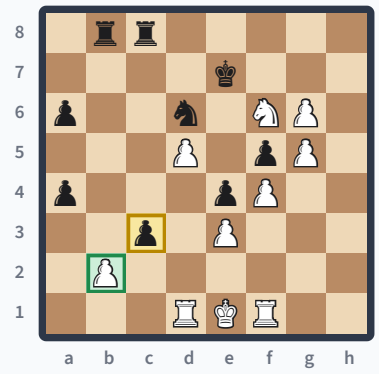
WEAK PAWNS

The price of a pawn that no other pawn can protect

Lesson 9 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

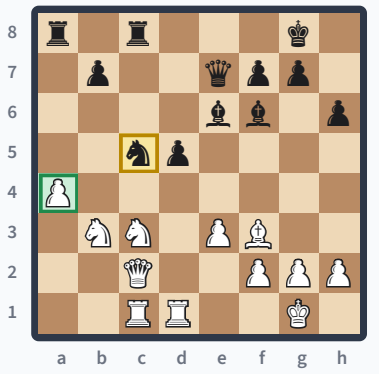


`37...cxb2 38.Rh1 Nc4`

- **Win rate with an isolated pawn: 26%/45%/29%**
- On average it costs little: it brings open files and activity.
- A weak pawn ties down pieces to defend it: that is often worth more than the pawn itself.
- Araiza Munoz v Alekhine, Pasadena 1932: **37...cxb2!** (winning 1 point).

2. Nesterov–Geller

WEAK PAWN

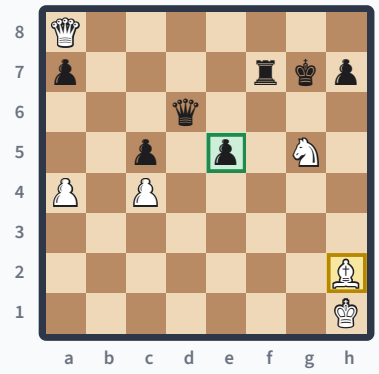


`21...Nxa4 22.Nxd5 Rxc2`

- Black wins a weak pawn.
- **21...Nxa4!** 22.Nxd5 Rxc2: Black is winning (engine +5.0).
- Nesterov v Geller, Tiraspol 1994

3. Petrosian–Simagin

WEAK PAWN

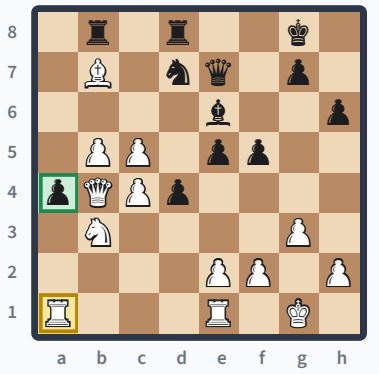


`45.Bxe5+ Qxe5 46.Qh8+`

- White wins a weak pawn.
- **45.Bxe5+!** 45...Qxe5 46.Qh8+: White is winning (engine +4.5).
- Petrosian v Simagin, Moscow ch m 1956

4. So–Wojtaszek: 26.Rxa4!

WEAK PAWN



`26.Rxa4 Rxb7 27.c6`

- White wins a weak pawn.
- **26.Rxa4!** 26...Rxb7 27.c6: White is winning (engine +4.1).
- So v Wojtaszek, 79th Tata Steel GpA 2017

Attacking Weak Pawns

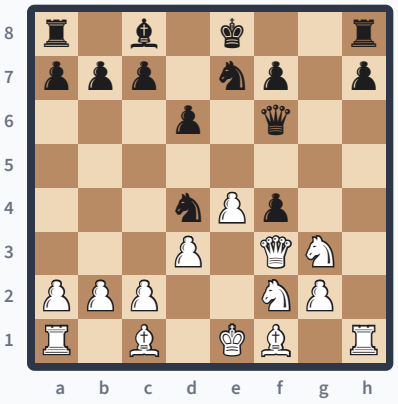
1. Fix it (stop it advancing), attack it more times than it is defended, then win it.
2. Blockade the square in front of it, ideally with a Knight.
3. Trade the pieces that defend it actively.

PUZZLES: WEAK PAWNS

Six positions from master games

Lesson 9 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

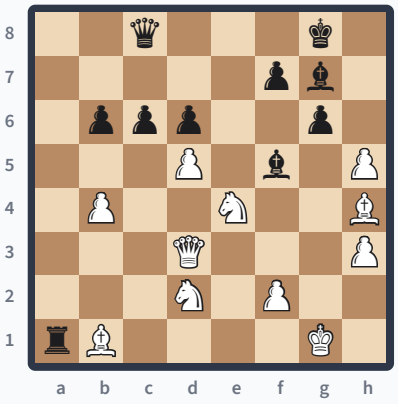
1 Find the best move for White!



Anderssen v Kipping
Manchester m 1857

Answer:

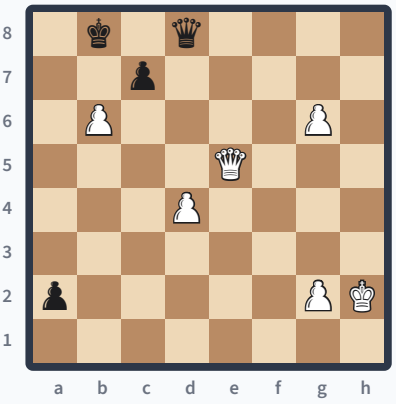
2 Find the best move for Black!



Kupreichik v Anand
GMA-Open 1988

Answer:

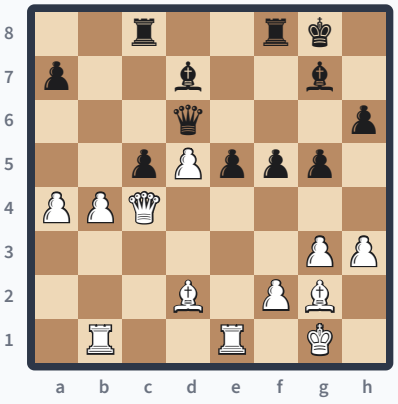
3 Find the best move for White!



Vachier Lagrave v Aronian
3rd Norway Chess 2015

Answer:

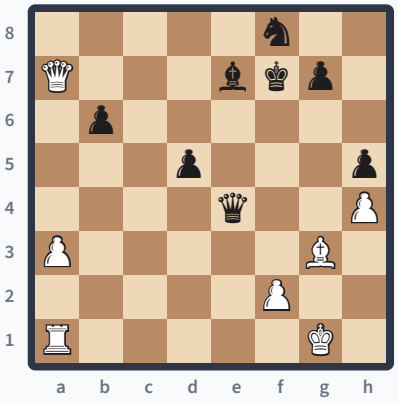
4 Find the best move for White!



Caruana v Alekseev
World Cup 2009

Answer:

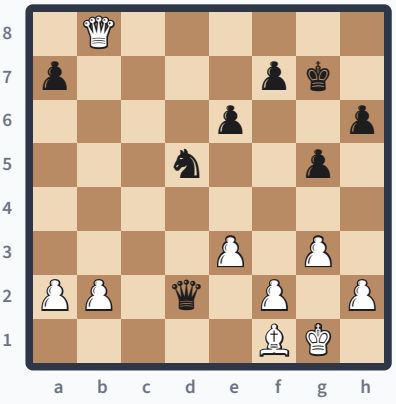
5 Find the best move for White!



Gelfand v Mikhalchishin
Minsk Int 1986

Answer:

6 Find the best move for White!



Kortschnoj v Plachetka
AUT-chT9596 1996

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

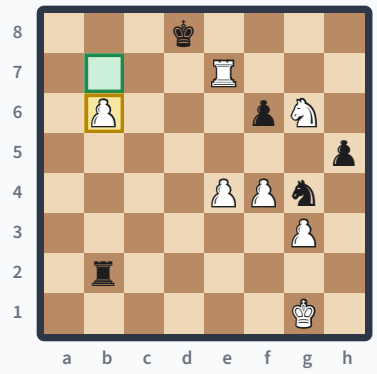
PASSED PAWNS

Worth more with every step

Lesson 10 · Endgame
Level 5 Endgame

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

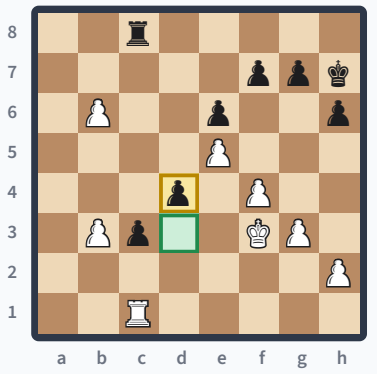


`42.b7 Rb1+ 43.Kg2`

- **Win rate with a passer on the 6th: 46%/39%/15%**
- **Win rate with a passer on the 7th: 52%/36%/12%**
- A passed pawn on the 4th rank is a small plus; on the 6th or 7th it can be worth a piece.
- Areshchenko v Aronian, FIDE World Cup 2015: **42.b7!** White is winning (engine +3.6).

2. Kortschnoj–Adorjan

PASSED PAWN

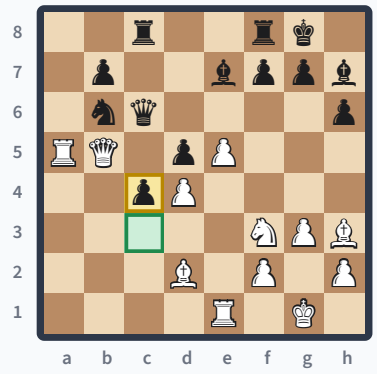


`36...d3 37.b7 d2`

- Black has a dangerous passed pawn.
- **36...d3!** 37.b7 d2: Black is winning (engine +4.8).
- Kortschnoj v Adorjan, Cannes 1986

3. Ponomariov–Gelfand

PASSED PAWN

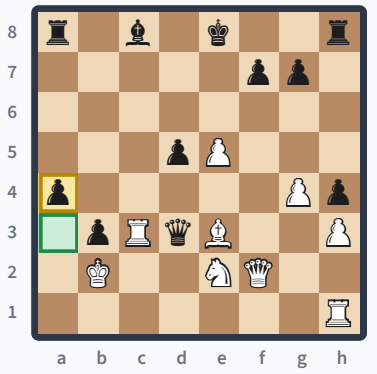


`25...c3 26.Bc1 Ra8`

- Black has a dangerous passed pawn.
- **25...c3!** 26.Bc1 Ra8: Black is clearly better (engine +2.5).
- Ponomariov v Gelfand, World Cup 2009

4. Sutovsky–Giri

PASSED PAWN



`28...a3+ 29.Ka1 b2+`

- Black has a dangerous passed pawn.
- **28...a3+!** 29.Ka1 b2+: Black is winning (engine +3.0).
- Sutovsky v Giri, Jubilee Open 2009

Passed Pawns

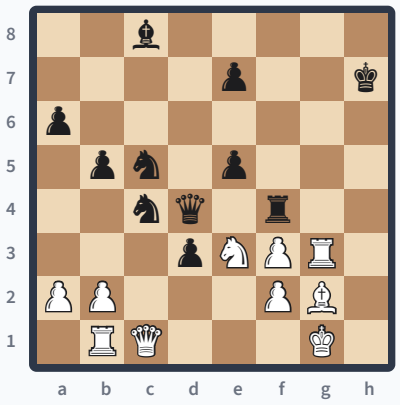
1. Push when the square in front is safe; support it with the King in the endgame.
2. A protected or outside passed pawn is worth even more.
3. Against it: blockade the square in front with a piece.

PUZZLES: PASSED PAWNS

Six positions from master games

Lesson 10 · Endgame Puzzles
Level 5 Endgame

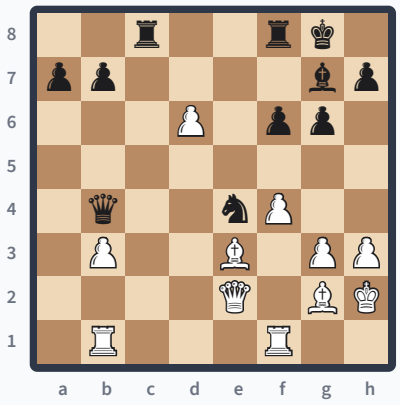
1 **Find the best move for Black!**



Lautier v Leko
Tilburg Fontys 1997

Answer:

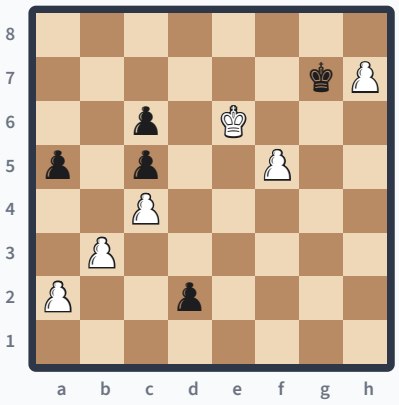
2 **Find the best move for White!**



Smyslov v Simagin
URS-ch28 1961

Answer:

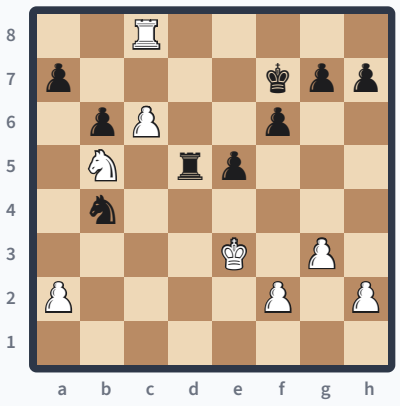
3 **Find the best move for White!**



Tal v Panno
Rio Hondo 1987

Answer:

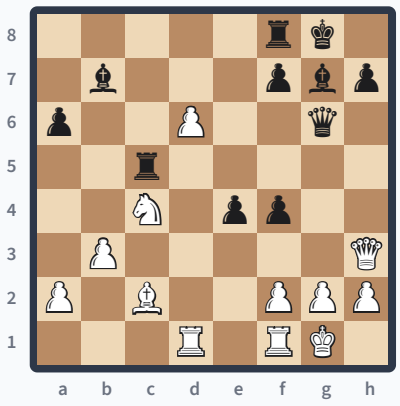
4 **Find the best move for White!**



Botvinnik v Stahlberg
Amsterdam olm 1954

Answer:

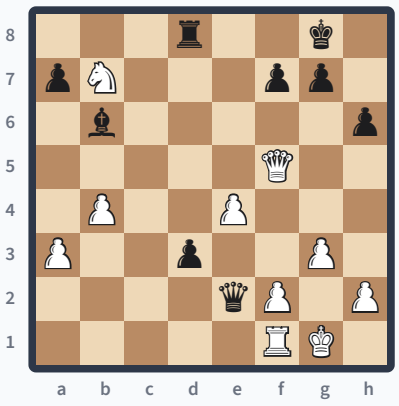
5 **Find the best move for White!**



Grischuk v Jakovenko
Aeroflot Open 2003

Answer:

6 **Find the best move for Black!**



Larsen v Hernandez
Las Palmas 1977

Answer:

Tip: convert step by step: stop counterplay, trade pieces, then push the passed pawn.

Score: ____ / 6

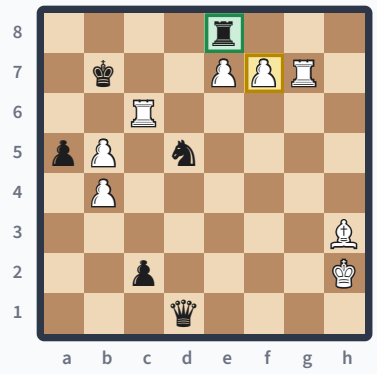
KING SAFETY

What an exposed King costs

Lesson 11 · Attack
Level 5 Attack

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

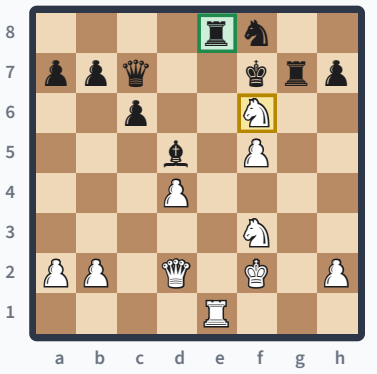


`57.fxe8=Q Qe2+ 58.Bg2`

- **Win rate with the enemy King exposed: 33%/38%/29%**
- It counts only if you can open lines quickly.
- Every open line to the King helps the attack.
- Kortschnoj v Salov, Belgrade 1987: **57.fxe8=Q!** (winning 13 points).

2. Jussupow–Spassky

EXPOSED KING

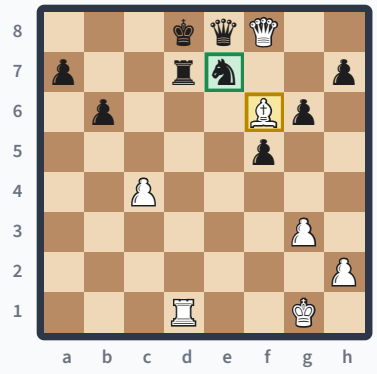


`31.Nxe8 Bxf3 32.Nxc7`

- The enemy King has lost its pawn cover.
- **31.Nxe8!** 31...Bxf3 32.Nxc7, winning 11 points.
- Jussupow v Spassky, Candidats Tournament 1985

3. Spassky–Gufeld

EXPOSED KING

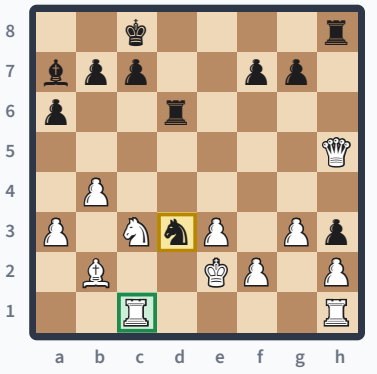


`41.Bxe7+ Kc7 42.Qxe8`

- The enemy King has lost its pawn cover.
- **41.Bxe7+!** 41...Kc7 42.Qxe8, winning 7 points.
- Spassky v Gufeld, Wellington 1988

4. Aronian–Nakamura

EXPOSED KING



`23...Nxc1+ 24.Rxc1 Rxh5`

- The enemy King has lost its pawn cover.
- **23...Nxc1+!** 24.Rxc1 Rxh5, winning 11 points.
- Aronian v Nakamura, 3rd Norway Chess 2015

Measuring King Safety

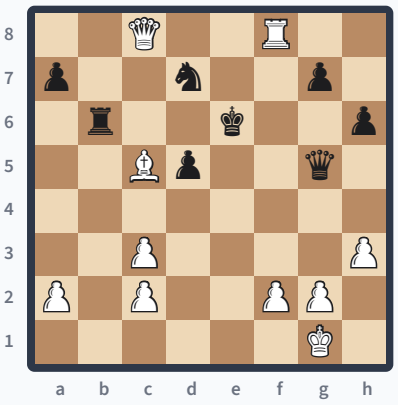
1. Count pawns in front of each King, open files and diagonals towards it, and attackers against defenders.
2. Keep queens on when the enemy King is exposed; trade them when yours is.
3. Bring one more attacker than there are defenders.

PUZZLES: KING SAFETY

Six positions from master games

Lesson 11 · Attack Puzzles
Level 5 Attack

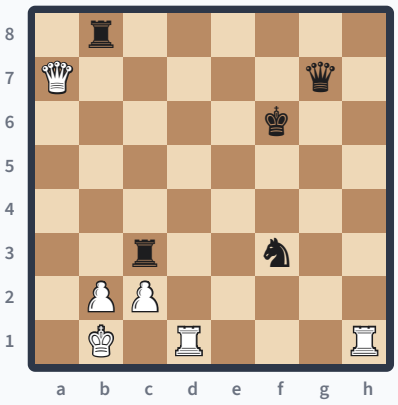
1 **Find the best move for White!**



Eichborn v Anderssen
Breslau m 1855

Answer:

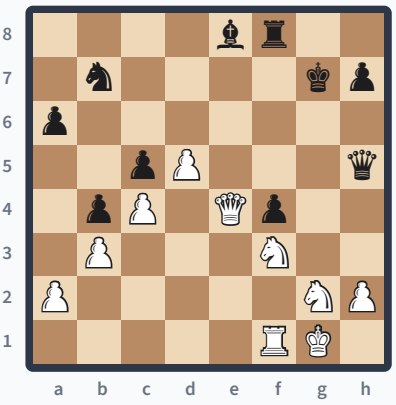
2 **Find the best move for White!**



Carlsen v Snarheim
TCh-NOR 2003

Answer:

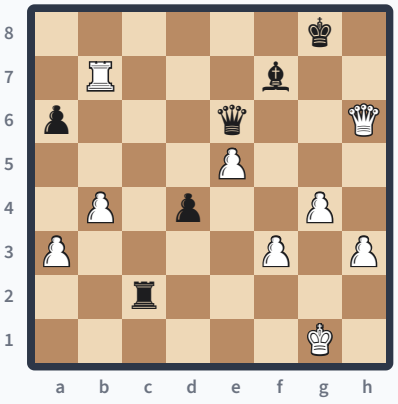
3 **Find the best move for White!**



Geller v Langeweg
IBM 1970

Answer:

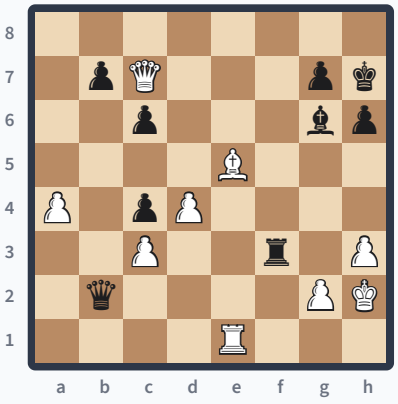
4 **Find the best move for White!**



Karpov v Mestel
London 1984

Answer:

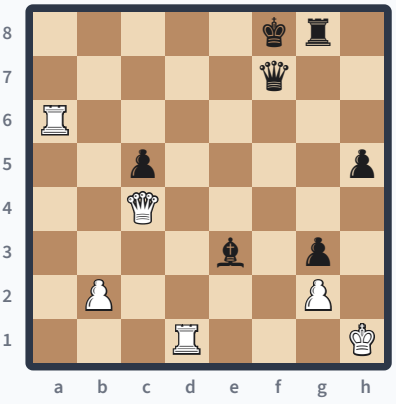
5 **Find the best move for Black!**



Gerstenfeld v Keres
URS-ch12 1940

Answer:

6 **Find the best move for White!**



Korchnoi v Cebalo
XVI WSen 2006

Answer:

Tip: count the attackers near the enemy King against the defenders. More attackers? Go for it!

Score: ____ / 6

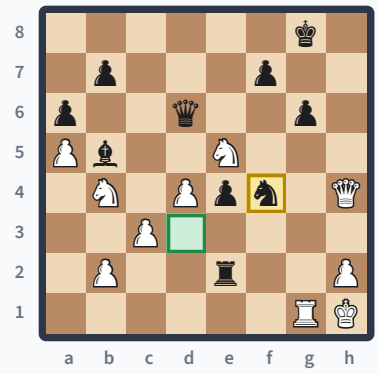
PIECE ACTIVITY

Rook on the 7th, open files and outposts

Lesson 12 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

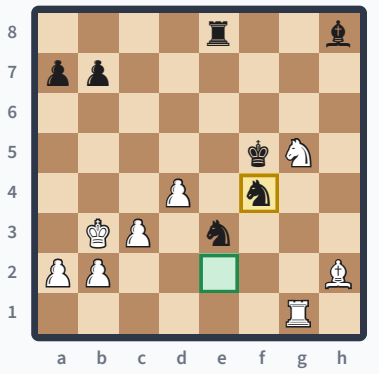


`37...Nd3 38.Ng4 Qf4`

- **Win rate with a Rook on the 7th: 34%/51%/15%**
- A Rook on the 7th rarely loses: it attacks pawns from the side and traps the King.
- Activity is a "soft" advantage that wins hard material later.
- Anand v Mamedyarov, Vugar Gashimov Mem 2019: **37...Nd3!** Black is winning (engine +3.4).

2. Anderssen–Mayet

ACTIVE PIECE

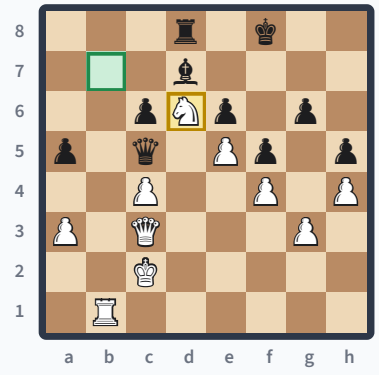


`30...Ne2 31.Nf7 Re6`

- Black activates a piece.
- **30...Ne2!** 31.Nf7 Re6: Black is clearly better (engine +2.1).
- Anderssen v Mayet, Berlin m1 1855

3. Anand–Novoselski

ACTIVE PIECE

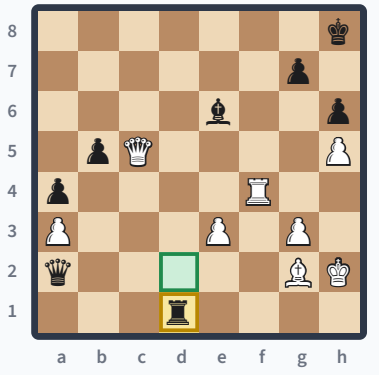


`37.Nb7 Qf2+ 38.Qd2`

- White activates a piece.
- **37.Nb7!** 37...Qf2+ 38.Qd2: White is winning (engine +3.6).
- Anand v Novoselski, Rome op 1990

4. Bluebaum–Anand

ACTIVE PIECE



`43...Rd2 44.Qc6 Qd5`

- Black activates a piece.
- **43...Rd2!** 44.Qc6 Qd5: Black is clearly better (engine +2.7).
- Bluebaum v Anand, Bundesliga 2018-19

Active Pieces

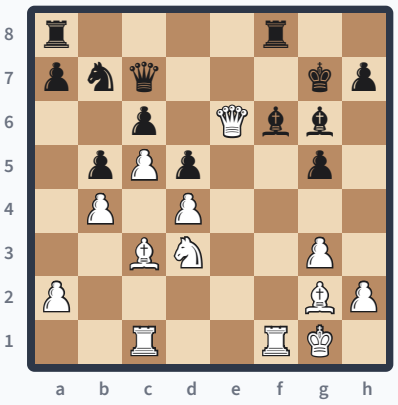
1. Rooks to open files and the 7th rank; Knights to outposts; Bishops to open diagonals.
2. An active piece is often worth a pawn: don't trade it for a passive one.
3. Activate first, then attack.

PUZZLES: PIECE ACTIVITY

Six positions from master games

Lesson 12 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

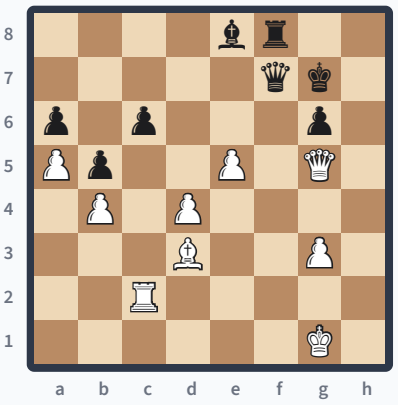
1 Find the best move for White!



Bronstein v Antoshin
Moscow-ch 1981

Answer:

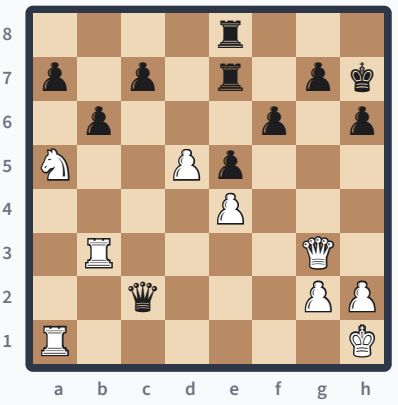
2 Find the best move for White!



Euwe v Flohr
Amsterdam/Karlsbad m 1932

Answer:

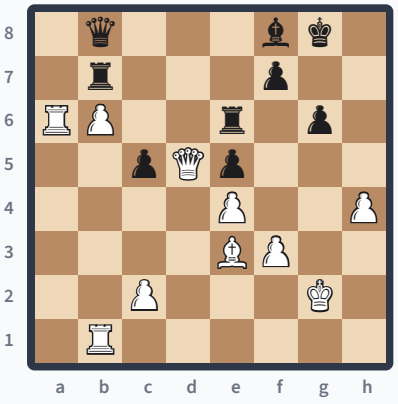
3 Find the best move for White!



Vallejo Pons v Grischuk
Wch U14 1996

Answer:

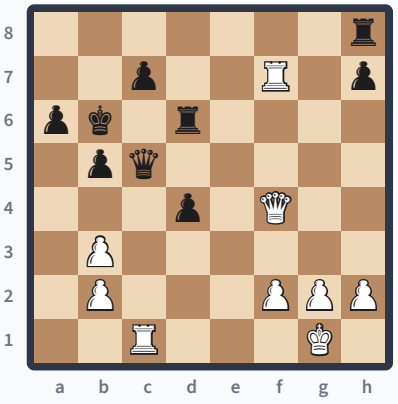
4 Find the best move for White!



Ivanchuk v Kramnik
FIDE Candidates 2013

Answer:

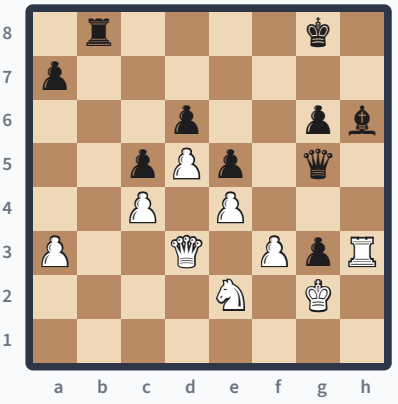
5 Find the best move for Black!



Keres v Spassky
Candidats Tournament 1956

Answer:

6 Find the best move for Black!



Berczes v Carlsen
FSGM December 2003

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

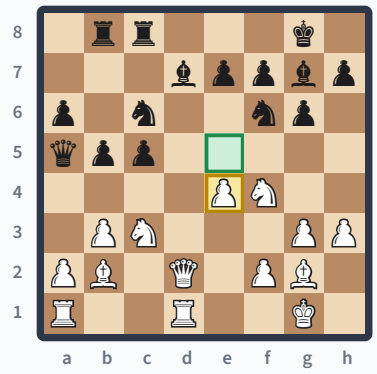
STATIC VS DYNAMIC

Advantages that last, and advantages that fade

Lesson 13 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. Two Kinds of Advantage

TECHNIQUE

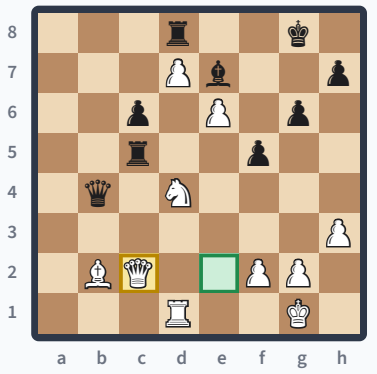


`18.e5 Nxe5 19.Ncd5`

- **Static** advantages last: material, structure, the better minor piece.
- **Dynamic** advantages fade: time, initiative, activity. They must be used at once.
- Ricardi v Polgar, Buenos Aires 1992: **18.e5!** White is clearly better (engine +2.9).

2. Alekhine–Treybal

DYNAMIC PLAY

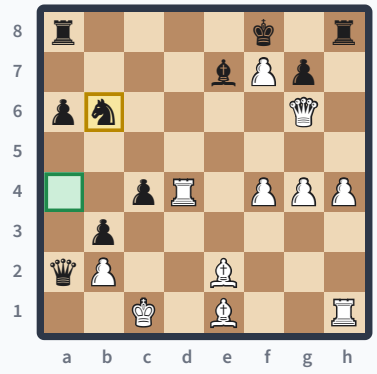


`29.Qe2 Kf8 30.Rd3`

- White is material down but has activity.
- **29.Qe2!** 29...Kf8 30.Rd3: White is clearly better (engine +2.7).
- Alekhine v Treybal, Semmering 1926

3. Donchenko–Caruana

DYNAMIC PLAY

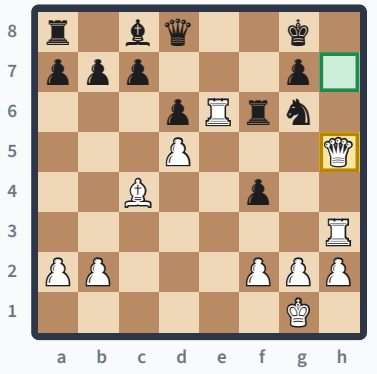


`25...Na4 26.Qb1 Ba3`

- Black is material down but has activity.
- **25...Na4!** 26.Qb1 Ba3: Black is clearly better (engine +2.9).
- Donchenko v Caruana, 83rd Tata Steel Masters 2021

4. Euwe–O'Hanlon

DYNAMIC PLAY



`20.Qh7+ Kf8 21.Qh8+`

- White is material down but has activity.
- **20.Qh7+!** 20...Kf8 21.Qh8+: White is clearly better (engine +2.0).
- Euwe v O'Hanlon, Hastings-C 1919

Static or Dynamic?

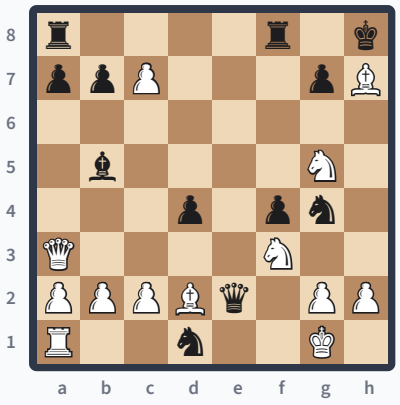
1. Material down? Look for dynamic compensation and act before it disappears.
2. Material up? Kill the dynamics first (prophylaxis), then let the static advantage win.
3. The side with the dynamic edge wants complications; the side with the static edge wants simplicity.

PUZZLES: STATIC VS DYNAMIC

Six positions from master games

Lesson 13 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

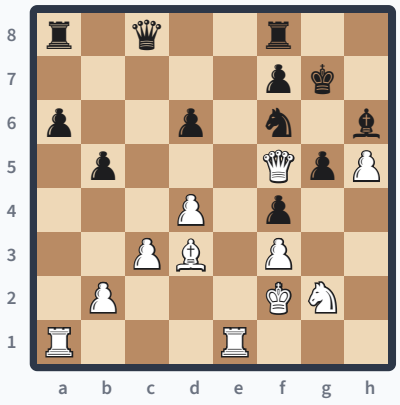
1 **White is material down. Find the best move!**



Steinitz v Pillsbury
St Petersburg9596 1895

Answer:

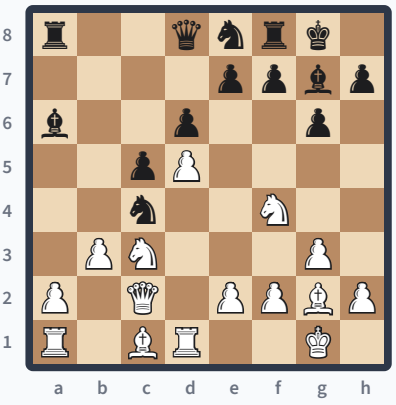
2 **White is material down. Find the best move!**



Bogoljubow v Reti
Berlin 1919

Answer:

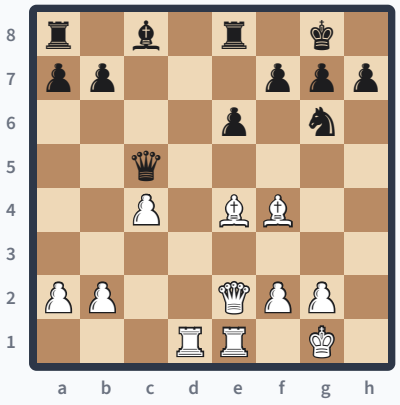
3 **Black is material down. Find the best move!**



Portisch v Lalic
EU-chT (Men) 1992

Answer:

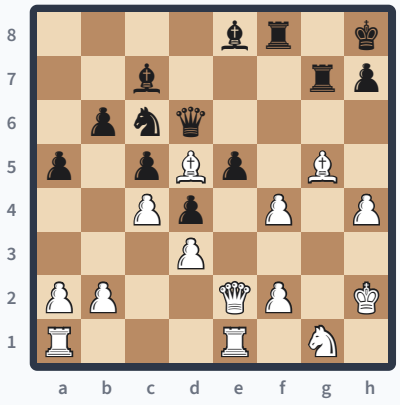
4 **White is material down. Find the best move!**



Schlechter v Tarrasch
Ostende 1907

Answer:

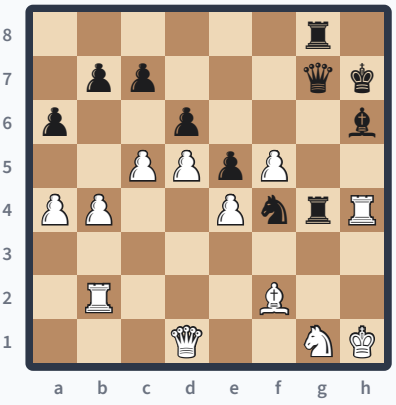
5 **Black is material down. Find the best move!**



Sznapik v Karpov
Skopje ol (Men) fin-A 1972

Answer:

6 **Black is material down. Find the best move!**



Botvinnik v Szabo
EU-chT 1965

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

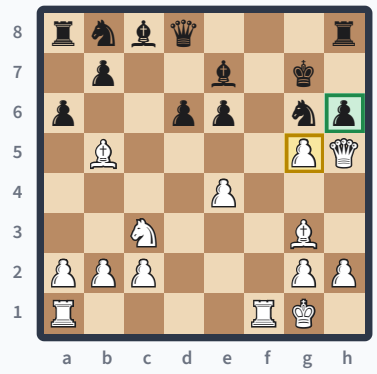
USE IT OR LOSE IT

Cash in a lead in development before it disappears

Lesson 14 · Openings
Level 5 Openings

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

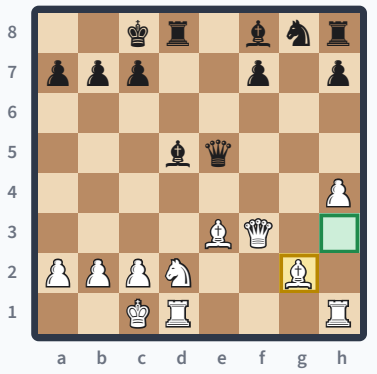


`16.gxh6+ Rxh6 17.Rf7+`

- A development lead disappears in a few moves. Open the position at once, usually with a pawn break or a sacrifice.
- Target the King in the centre and the undeveloped side.
- Spassky v Pilnik, Gothenburg Interzonal 1955: **16.gxh6+!** White keeps an edge (engine +0.6).

2. Steinitz–Showalter

OPEN IT UP

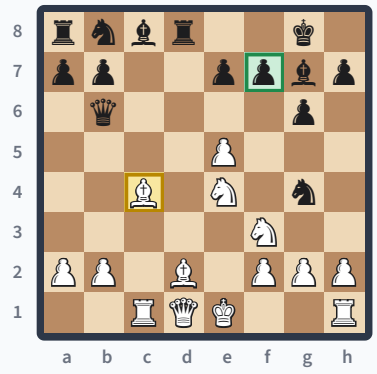


`16.Bh3+ f5 17.Bxf5+`

- White uses the lead in development.
- **16.Bh3+!** 16...f5 17.Bxf5+, winning 1 point.
- Steinitz v Showalter, Nuremberg 1896

3. Petrosian–Benko

OPEN IT UP

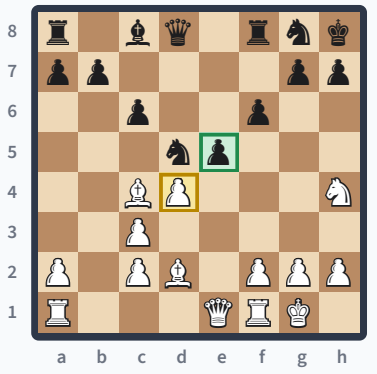


`13.Bxf7+ Kh8 14.h3`

- White uses the lead in development.
- **13.Bxf7+!** 13...Kh8 14.h3, winning 1 point.
- Petrosian v Benko, Candidats Tournament 1962

4. Apsenieks–Euwe

OPEN IT UP



`15.dxe5 fxe5 16.Nf3`

- White uses the lead in development.
- **15.dxe5!** 15...fxe5 16.Nf3: White is clearly better (engine +1.4).
- Apsenieks v Euwe, Paris f-A 1924

Converting Time

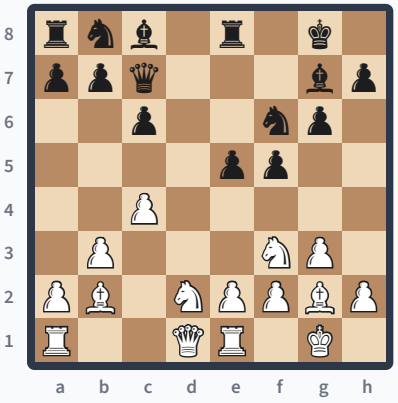
1. Open lines: pawn breaks and exchanges in the centre.
2. Stop the opponent from castling or developing in peace.
3. If the attack is not there, turn time into a lasting edge: material or structure.

PUZZLES: USE IT OR LOSE IT

Six positions from master games

Lesson 14 · Openings Puzzles
Level 5 Openings

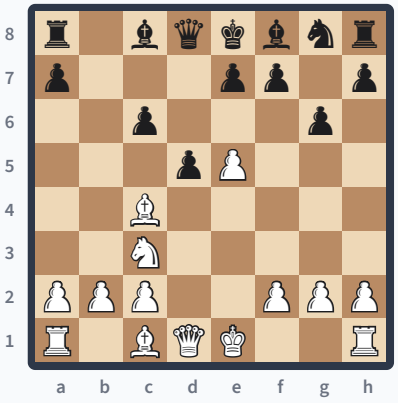
1 **White to move. Use your lead now!**



Kovalyov v Nakamura
9th TIM 2008

Answer:

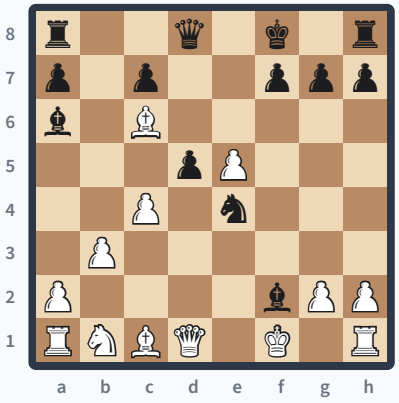
2 **White to move. Use your lead now!**



Geller v Stein
URS-ch34 1966

Answer:

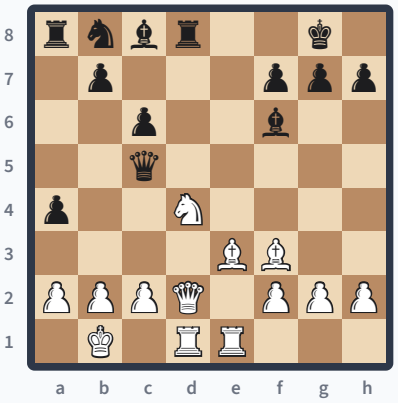
3 **Black to move. Use your lead now!**



Pinedo v Anderssen
Amsterdam 1861

Answer:

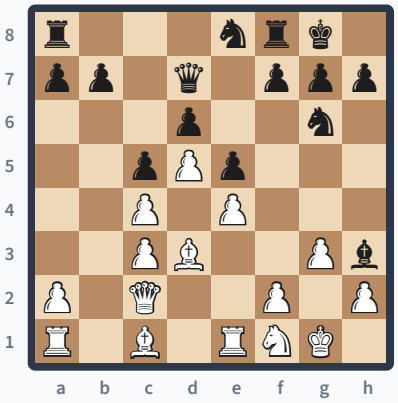
4 **White to move. Use your lead now!**



Leko v Barbero
HUN-chT1 1995

Answer:

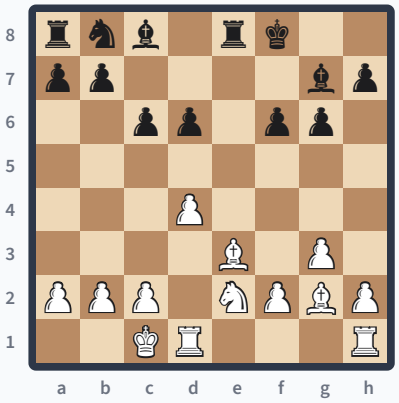
5 **Black to move. Use your lead now!**



Gligoric v Andersson
Niksic 1978

Answer:

6 **White to move. Use your lead now!**



Karpov v Piescikowski
Koszalin sim1 1997

Answer:

Tip: count the tempi: who is ahead in development, and how long will it last?

Score: ____ / 6

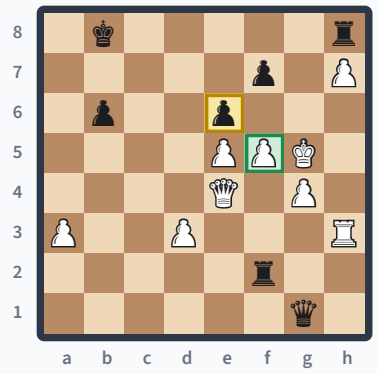
TRADE PIECES, NOT PAWNS

The technique of converting extra material

Lesson 15 · Endgame
Level 5 Endgame

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

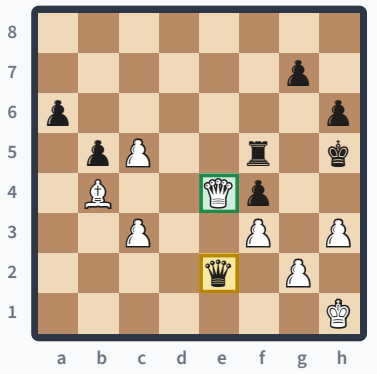


`38...exf5 39.Qd5 Qc1+`

- When ahead in material, every piece trade makes the extra material count more.
- Keep pawns on the board: with no pawns left, even a piece up can be a draw.
- Nepomniachtchi v Vitiugov, 67th ch-RUS 2014: **38...exf5!** (winning 1 point).

2. Schlechter–Lasker

SIMPLIFY

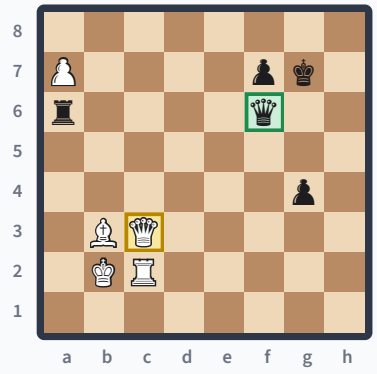


`49...Qxe4 50.fxe4 Rf6`

- Black is ahead in material and trades.
- **49...Qxe4!** 50.fxe4 Rf6: Black is winning (engine +4.4).
- Schlechter v Lasker, Paris 1900

3. Nepomniachtchi–Lintchevski

SIMPLIFY

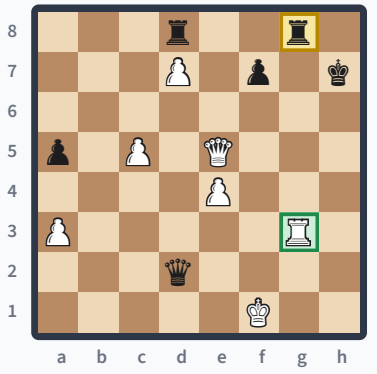


`60.Qxf6+ Kxf6 61.Rc6+`

- White is ahead in material and trades.
- **60.Qxf6+!** 60...Kxf6 61.Rc6+: White is winning (engine +8.4).
- Nepomniachtchi v Lintchevski, Young Stars of the World 2005

4. Olland–Alekhine

SIMPLIFY



`35...Rxg3 36.Qxg3 Rxd7`

- Black is ahead in material and trades.
- **35...Rxg3!** 36.Qxg3 Rxd7, winning 1 point.
- Olland v Alekhine, Scheveningen 1913

Converting Material

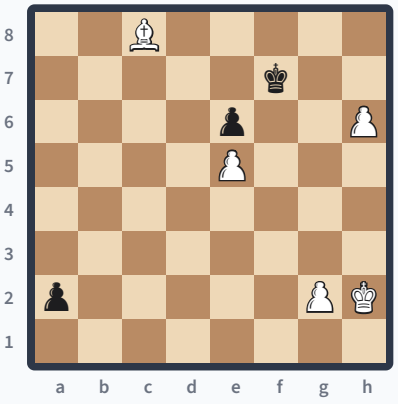
1. Trade pieces, especially the opponent's active ones; keep the pawns.
2. Avoid opposite-coloured Bishops and pawn-less endgames.
3. Return some material if it kills all counterplay (Lesson 23).

PUZZLES: TRADE PIECES, NOT PAWNS

Six positions from master games

Lesson 15 · Endgame Puzzles
Level 5 Endgame

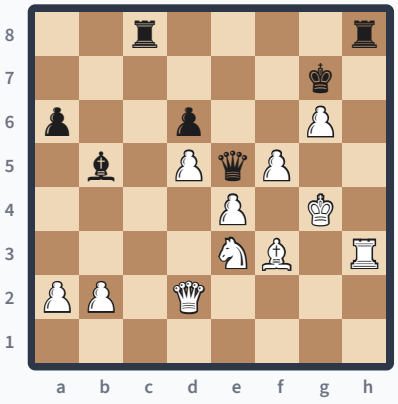
1 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Ivanchuk v Svidler
Linares 1998

Answer:

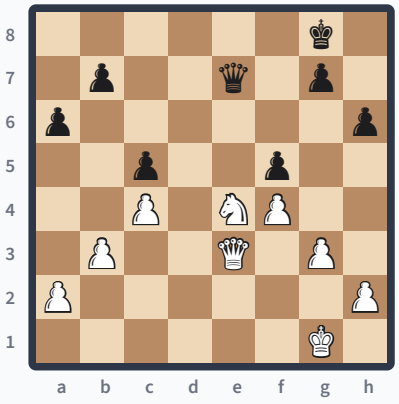
2 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Turner v Fischer
New York Rosenwald 1956

Answer:

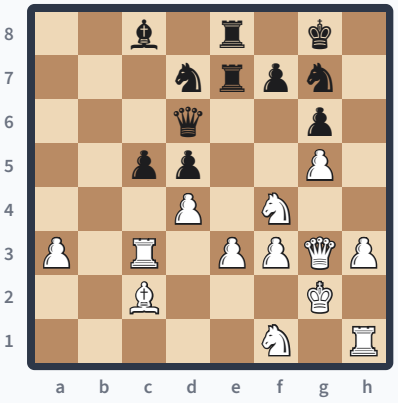
3 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Andersson v Hort
Gothenburg 1971

Answer:

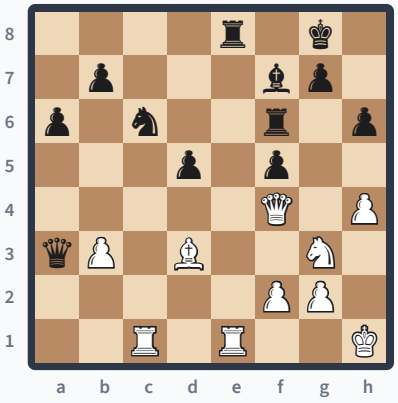
4 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Grischuk v Kasimdzhanov
FIDE WCh KO 2004

Answer:

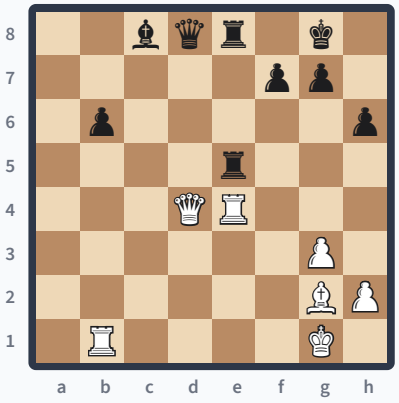
5 **Black is ahead. Find the best move!**



Marshall v Salwe
Lodz mt 1908

Answer:

6 **Black is ahead. Find the best move!**



Nakamura v Wang
39th Olympiad Men 2010

Answer:

Tip: convert step by step: stop counterplay, trade pieces, then push the passed pawn.

Score: ____ / 6

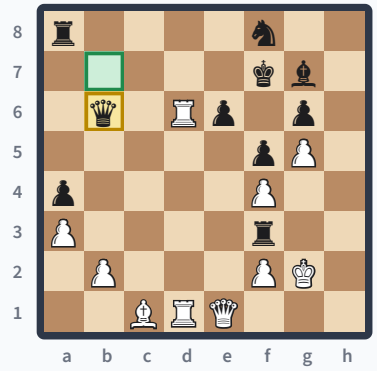
FIRST STOP THE COUNTERPLAY

Prophylaxis before cashing in

Lesson 16 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

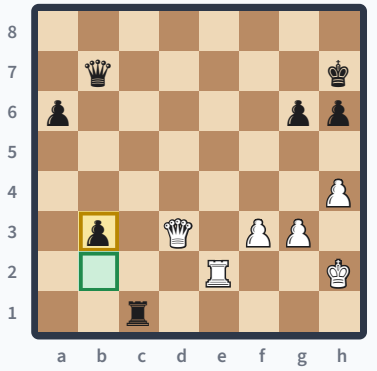


38...Qb7 39.Qb4 Rb3+

- The most common way to spoil a won position is to allow counterplay.
- Before every move ask: what is my opponent threatening, and what would he like to do next?
- Osnos v Kortschnoj, URS-ch sf 1958: **38...Qb7!** Black is winning (engine +4.4).

2. Hansen–Kortschnoj

PROPHYLAXIS

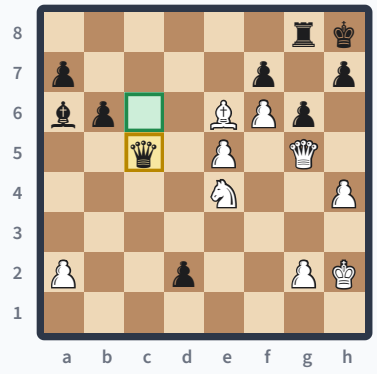


45...b2 46.Qa3 Rc2

- Black is better but must first stop the opponent's idea.
- **45...b2!** 46.Qa3 Rc2: Black is winning (engine +3.8).
- Hansen v Kortschnoj, Malmo 1996

3. Shirov–Vachier Lagrave

PROPHYLAXIS

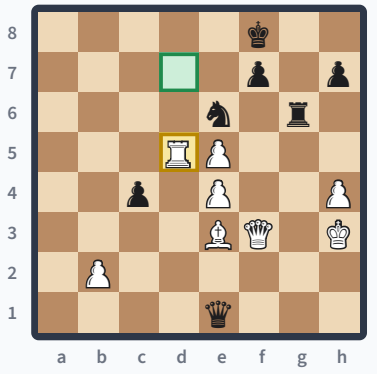


31...Qc6 32.Nd6 Qxd6

- Black is better but must first stop the opponent's idea.
- **31...Qc6!** 32.Nd6 Qxd6: Black is winning (engine +3.5).
- Shirov v Vachier Lagrave, 73rd Tata Steel GMA 2011

4. Topalov–Mamedyarov

PROPHYLAXIS



47.Rd7 f6 48.exf6

- White is better but must first stop the opponent's idea.
- **47.Rd7!** 47...f6 48.exf6, winning 1 point.
- Topalov v Mamedyarov, 10th Essent 2006

Prophylaxis

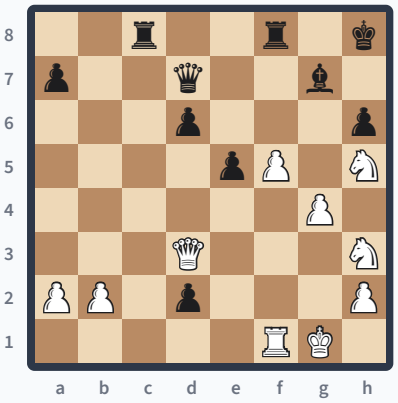
1. Stop the threat first, even if it costs a tempo.
2. Restrict the opponent's best piece before you go forward.
3. Petrosian and Karpov won many games just by preventing everything.

PUZZLES: FIRST STOP THE COUNTERPLAY

Six positions from master games

Lesson 16 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

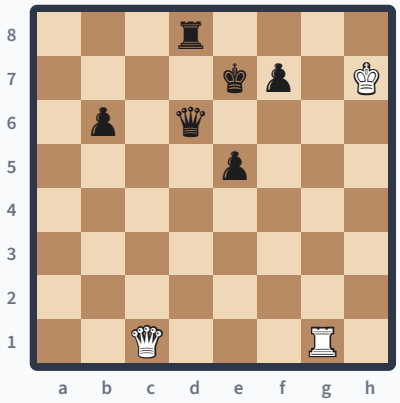
1 **Black to move. What does your opponent want?**



Christiansen v Kasparov
Moscow Interzonal 1982

Answer:

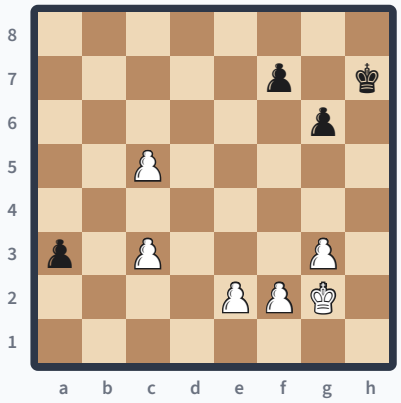
2 **Black to move. What does your opponent want?**



Janowsky v Marshall
Cambridge Springs 1904

Answer:

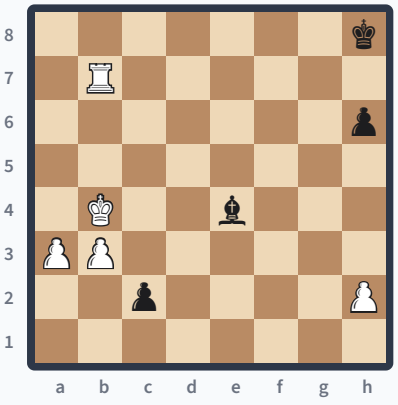
3 **White to move. What does your opponent want?**



Ding v Aggelis
51st World Juniors 2012

Answer:

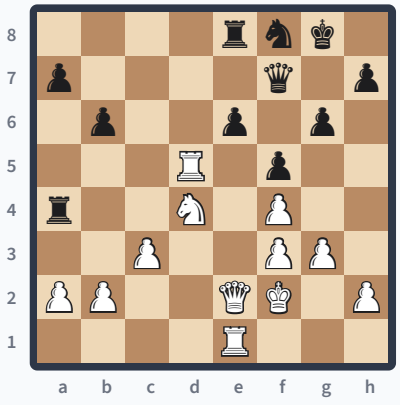
4 **White to move. What does your opponent want?**



Tarrasch v Marshall
Nuremberg m 1905

Answer:

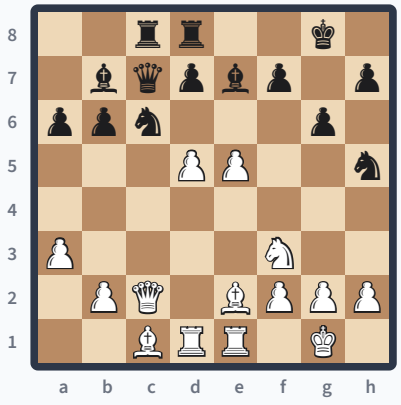
5 **White to move. What does your opponent want?**



Mason v Chigorin
London 1883

Answer:

6 **Black to move. What does your opponent want?**



Lautier v Larsen
Cannes schev 1989

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

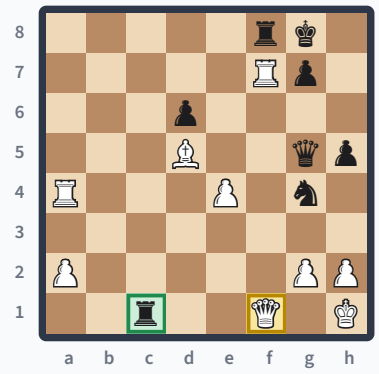
FROM TIME TO ATTACK

Turn a lead in development into a direct attack

Lesson 17 · Attack
Level 5 Attack

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

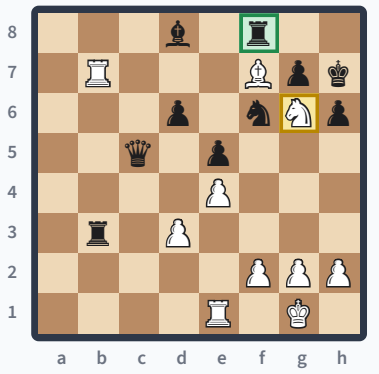


`32.Qxc1 Qxc1+ 33.Rf1+`

- More attackers than defenders near the King: that is the moment to strike.
- A sacrifice that opens the King is often the fastest conversion.
- Fischer v Sherwin, USA-ch 1957: **32.Qxc1!** (winning 5 points).

2. Kupreichik–Geller

ATTACK

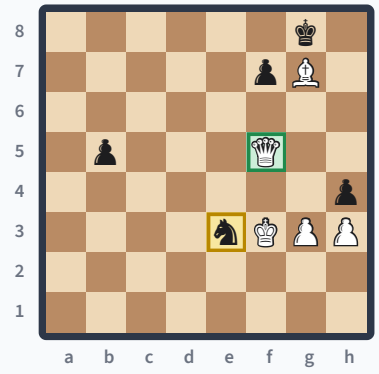


`26.Nxf8+ Kh8 27.Rxb3`

- White attacks the King.
- **26.Nxf8+!** 26...Kh8 27.Rxb3, winning 10 points.
- Kupreichik v Geller, Berliner Sommer 1991

3. Tiviakov–Nakamura

ATTACK

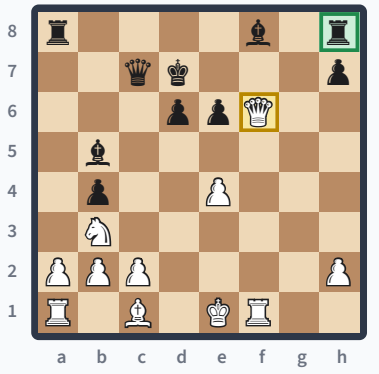


`55...Nxf5 56.Bc3 hxg3`

- Black attacks the King.
- **55...Nxf5!** 56.Bc3 hxg3, winning 10 points.
- Tiviakov v Nakamura, GMB 2004

4. Polgar–Van Wely

ATTACK



`19.Qxh8 Be7 20.Qxa8`

- White attacks the King.
- **19.Qxh8!** 19...Be7 20.Qxa8, winning 10 points.
- Polgar v Van Wely, Donner mem 1995

Converting into an Attack

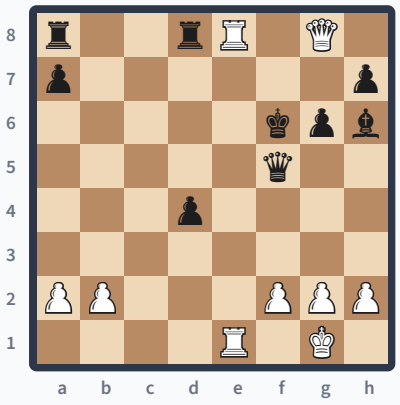
1. Count attackers and defenders around the King.
2. Open lines with pawn breaks or sacrifices; bring the last piece in.
3. If the attack runs out, make sure it has won something on the way.

PUZZLES: FROM TIME TO ATTACK

Six positions from master games

Lesson 17 · Attack Puzzles
Level 5 Attack

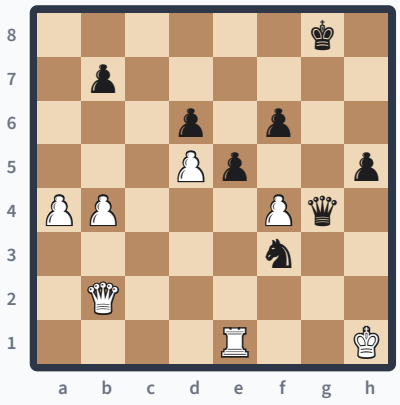
1 Find the blow for White!



Salwe v Rubinstein
Lodz-m 1903

Answer:

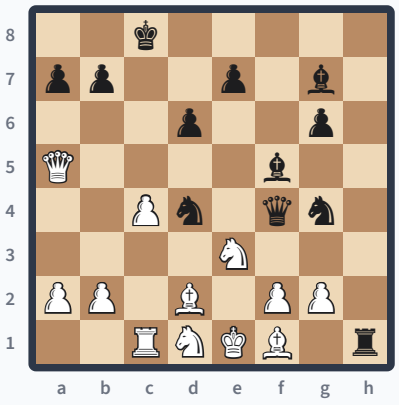
2 Find the blow for Black!



Levenfish v Alekhine
RUS-ch 1912

Answer:

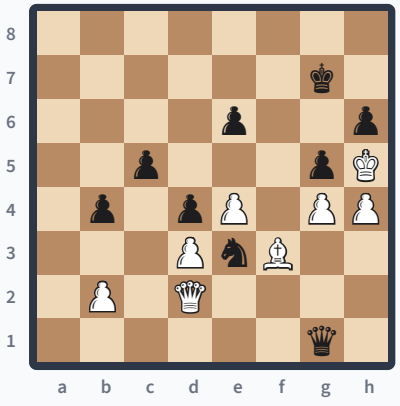
3 Find the blow for Black!



Szabo v Botvinnik
IBM 1966

Answer:

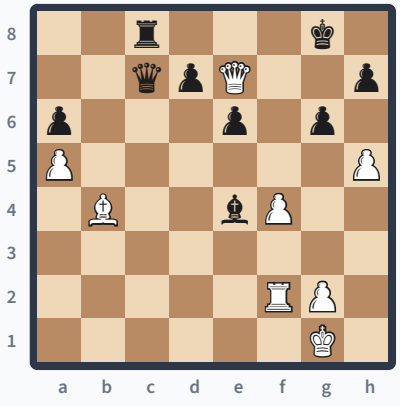
4 Find the blow for Black!



Bobrov v Grischuk
Moscow-ch op 1998

Answer:

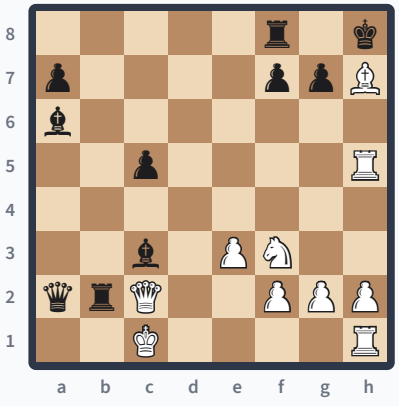
5 Find the blow for White!



Janosevic v Larsen
Copenhagen 1965

Answer:

6 Find the blow for Black!



Wahltuch v Rubinstein
London 1922

Answer:

Tip: count the attackers near the enemy King against the defenders. More attackers? Go for it!

Score: ____ / 6

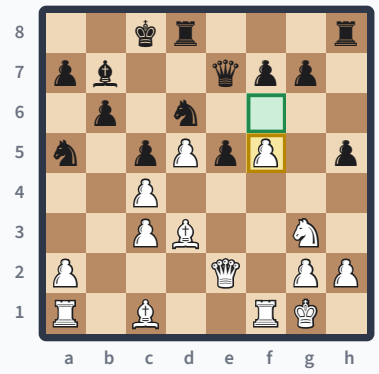
SQUEEZE, THEN BREAK

Turning space into a won position

Lesson 18 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

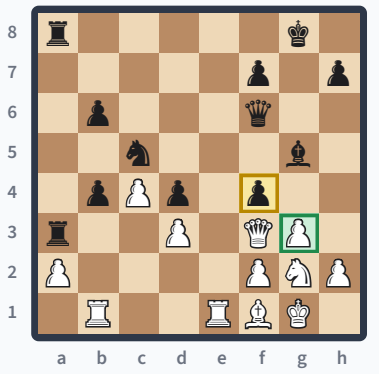


`17.f6 gxf6 18.Nxh5`

- First squeeze: take away every useful square from the cramped side.
- Then break with a pawn on the side where the enemy pieces are weakest.
- Botvinnik v Silich, URS-ch06 sf1 1929: **17.f6!** White is clearly better (engine +1.1).

2. Tarrasch–Alekhine

THE BREAK

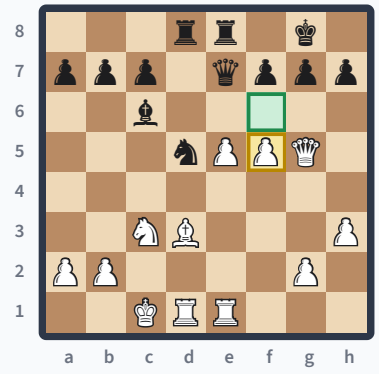


`31...fxg3 32.Qxf6 gxh2+`

- Black has more space and breaks at the right moment.
- **31...fxg3!** 32.Qxf6 gxh2+: Black is clearly better (engine +1.1).
- Tarrasch v Alekhine, Semmering 1926

3. Alekhine–Marshall

THE BREAK

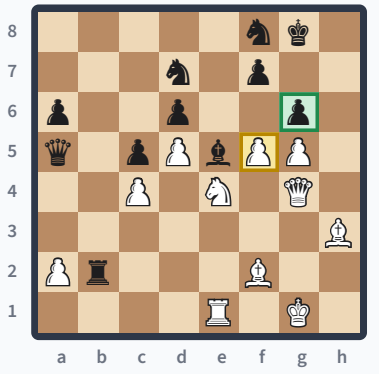


`21.f6 Qf8 22.Bc4`

- White has more space and breaks at the right moment.
- **21.f6!** 21...Qf8 22.Bc4: White is clearly better (engine +2.8).
- Alekhine v Marshall, Baden-Baden 1925

4. Geller–Hickl: 34.fxg6!

THE BREAK



`34.fxg6 fxg6 35.Qh4`

- White has more space and breaks at the right moment.
- **34.fxg6!** 34...fxg6 35.Qh4: White is clearly better (engine +1.4).
- Geller v Hickl, Dortmund-A 1989

Squeeze and Break

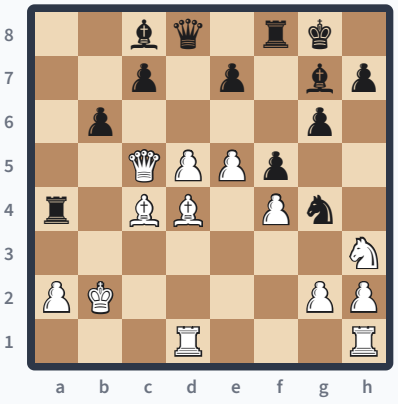
1. Do not open the position too early: the cramped side wants exchanges.
2. Prepare the break with all pieces behind it.
3. Break where you are stronger.

PUZZLES: SQUEEZE, THEN BREAK

Six positions from master games

Lesson 18 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

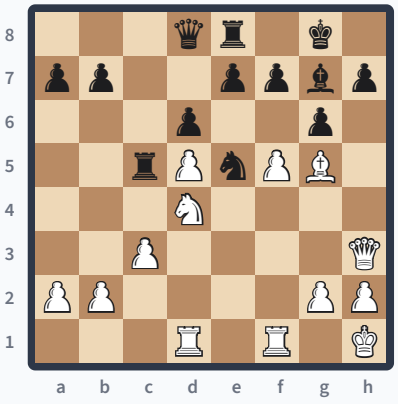
1 Find the break for White!



Ivanchuk v Durarbayli
TCh-TUR Super League 2019

Answer:

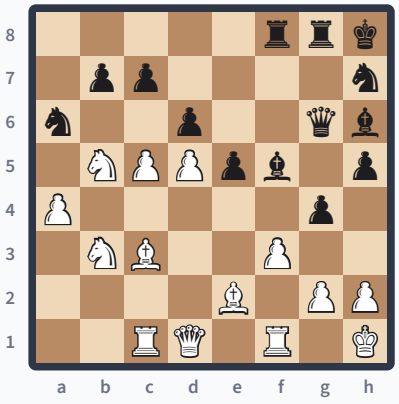
2 Find the break for White!



Leko v Turzo
Wch U16 1994

Answer:

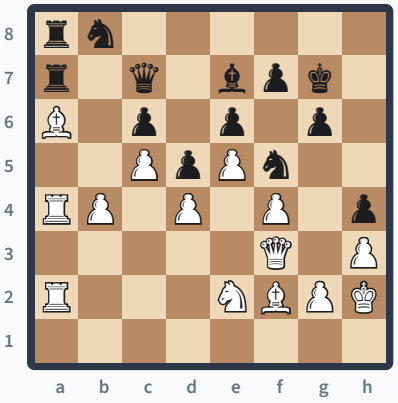
3 Find the break for White!



Gligoric v Geller
URS-JUG 1968

Answer:

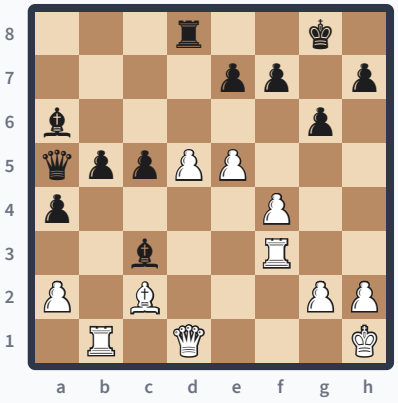
4 Find the break for White!



Grischuk v Kalantarian
Linares Anibal op 1999

Answer:

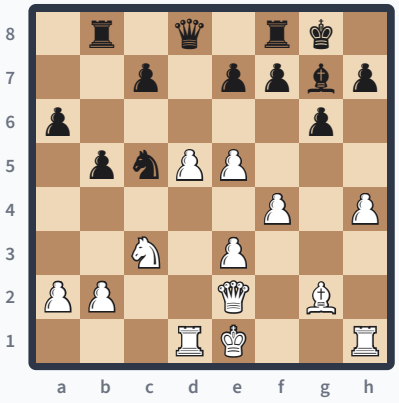
5 Find the break for White!



Dubov v Nepomniachtchi
73rd ch-RUS 2020

Answer:

6 Find the break for White!



Portisch v Simagin
Kecskemet 1966

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

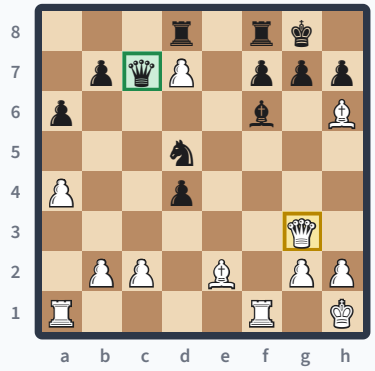
CHOOSE THE RIGHT ENDGAME

Turn a better pawn structure into a won endgame

Lesson 19 · Endgame
Level 5 Endgame

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

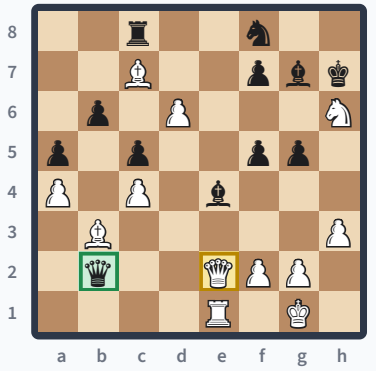


```
20.Qxc7 Nxc7 21.Rxf6
```

- Weak pawns and bad pieces count most in the endgame.
- Trading queens removes the opponent's counterplay against your King.
- Olafsson v Andersson, Las Palmas 1974: **20.Qxc7!** White is clearly better (engine +1.4).

2. Ljubojevic–Andersson

QUEEN TRADE

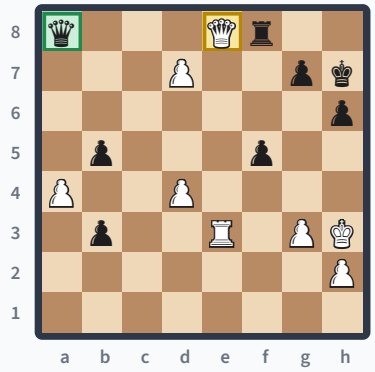


```
25.Qxb2 Bxb2 26.Nxf7
```

- White trades into a favourable endgame.
- **25.Qxb2!** 25...Bxb2 26.Nxf7, winning 1 point.
- Ljubojevic v Andersson, Hoogovens 1973

3. Botvinnik–Flohr

QUEEN TRADE

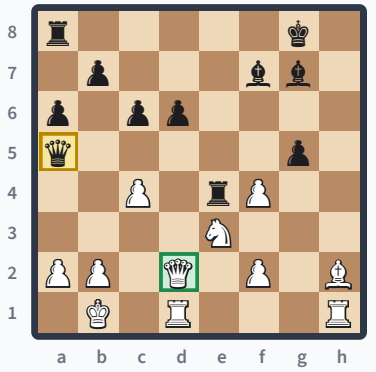


```
54.Qxa8 Rxa8 55.axb5
```

- White trades into a favourable endgame.
- **54.Qxa8!** 54...Rxa8 55.axb5, winning 1 point.
- Botvinnik v Flohr, Moscow 1936

4. Morrison–Capablanca

QUEEN TRADE



```
27...Qxd2 28.Rxd2 gxf4
```

- Black trades into a favourable endgame.
- **27...Qxd2!** 28.Rxd2 gxf4, winning 1 point.
- Morrison v Capablanca, New York 1918

Choosing the Endgame

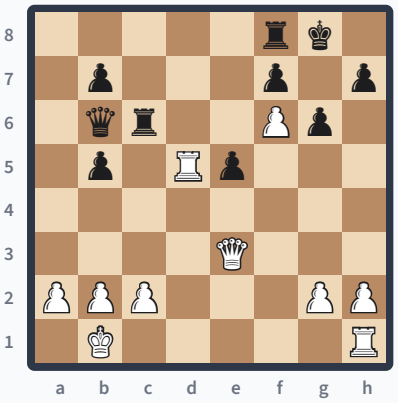
1. Count the pawn weaknesses: which ones will matter with queens off?
2. Trade the opponent's good pieces; keep your good ones.
3. Check the King: in the endgame it must reach the centre first.

PUZZLES: CHOOSE THE RIGHT ENDGAME

Six positions from master games

Lesson 19 · Endgame Puzzles
Level 5 Endgame

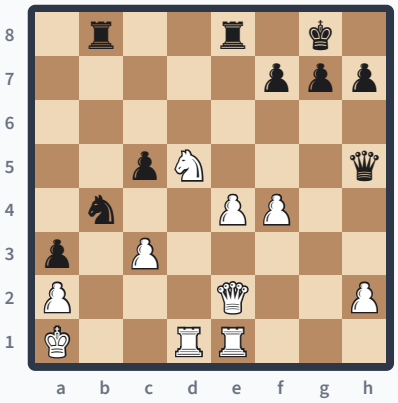
1 Find the best move for White!



Caruana v Vinh
FSGM July 2007

Answer:

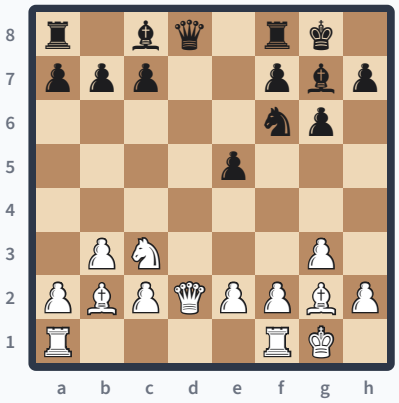
2 Find the best move for Black!



Caruana v Malakhov
FIDE World Cup 2013

Answer:

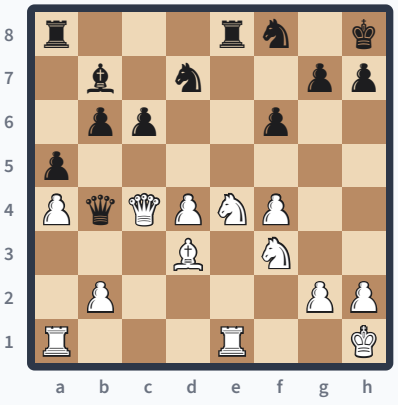
3 Find the best move for White!



Kortschnoj v Spassky
URS-ch23 1956

Answer:

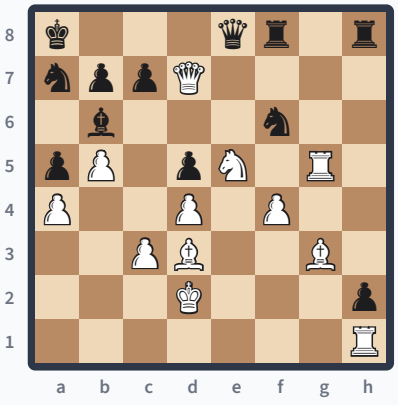
4 Find the best move for White!



Nakamura v Collins
X Anibal Open 2003

Answer:

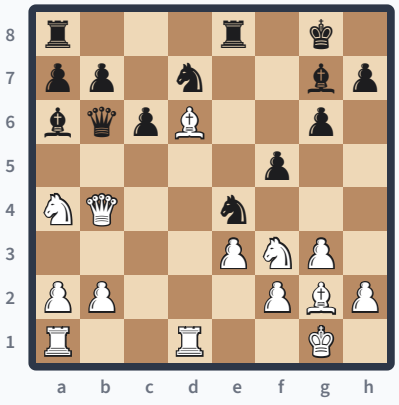
5 Find the best move for White!



Chajes v Nimzowitsch
Karlsbad 1923

Answer:

6 Find the best move for Black!



Ragnarsson v Mamedyarov
Reykjavik Open 2015

Answer:

Tip: convert step by step: stop counterplay, trade pieces, then push the passed pawn.

Score: ____ / 6

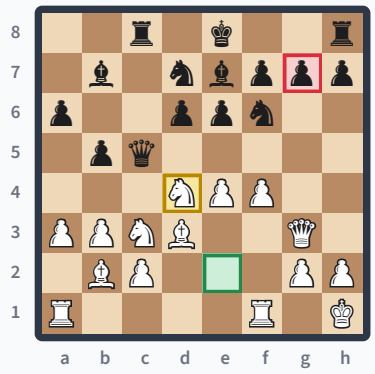
THE POISONED PAWN

A free pawn is worth less than the time it costs

Lesson 20 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. The Price of a Pawn

TECHNIQUE

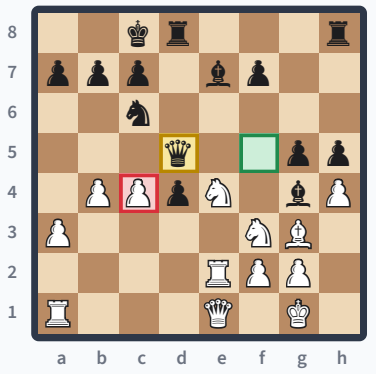


`19.Nde2 h5 20.h3`

- A pawn is worth one point; two or three tempi with the Queen offside can cost far more.
- Masters declined each of these pawns. The engine shows why.
- Luther v Bronstein, Copenhagen Unibank 1991: **19.Nde2!**

2. Medina Garcia–Keres

POISONED PAWN

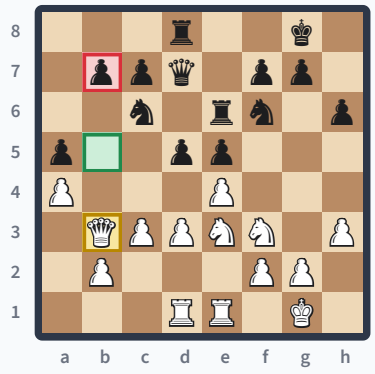


`18...Qf5 19.b5 Bxf3`

- The pawn on c4 (red) looks free.
- **18...Qxc4?** 19.Ned2 Qd3 20.Rxe7 (engine -1.1). Better: **18...Qf5!**
- Medina Garcia v Keres, Madrid 1943

3. Anand–Grischuk

POISONED PAWN

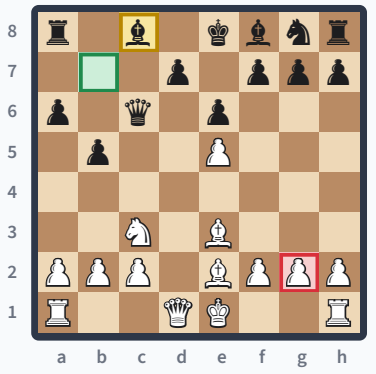


`18.Qb5 b6 19.Rd2`

- The pawn on b7 (red) looks free.
- **18.Qxb7?** 18...Rb8 19.Qa6 Rb6 (engine -4.3). Better: **18.Qb5!**
- Anand v Grischuk, 6th Sinquefield Cup 2018

4. Petrosian–Taimanov

POISONED PAWN



`9...Bb7 10.Bf3 Qc7`

- The pawn on g2 (red) looks free.
- **9...Qxg2?** 10.Bf3 Qh3 11.Bxa8 (engine -6.8). Better: **9...Bb7!**
- Petrosian v Taimanov, URS-ch37 1969

Before You Grab

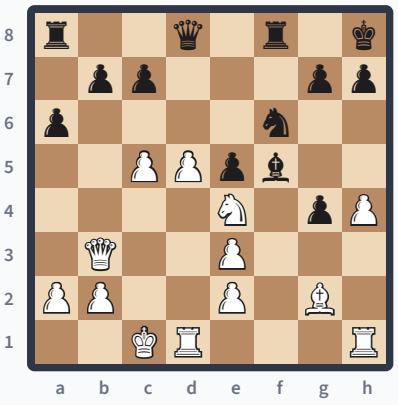
1. Ask what the opponent does next: open files, a trapped Queen, an attack on your King.
2. Count tempi: how many moves to bring the grabbing piece back?
3. If the pawn is truly free, take it. If in doubt, develop first.

PUZZLES: THE POISONED PAWN

Six positions from master games

Lesson 20 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

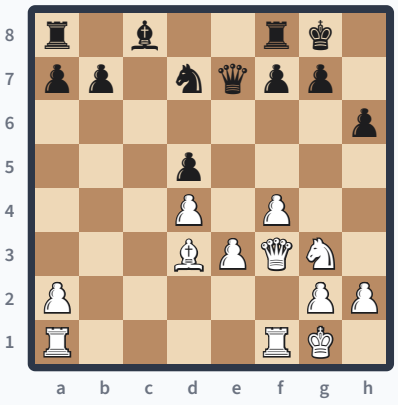
1 **White to move. Can you take on b7?**



Aronian v Short
Gibraltar Masters 2018

Answer:

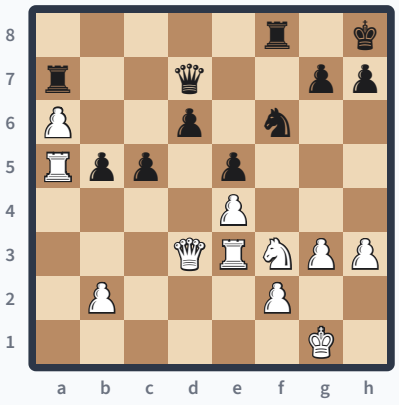
2 **White to move. Can you take on d5?**



Spassky v Kinnmark
Gothenburg 1971

Answer:

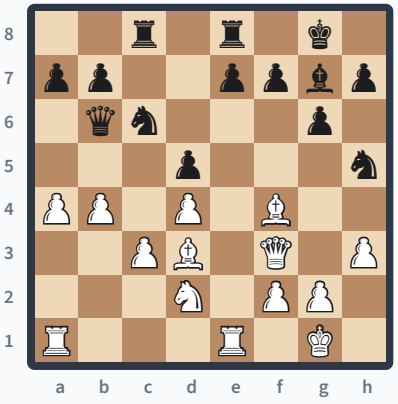
3 **Black to move. Can you take on h3?**



Giri v Zhigalko
42nd Olympiad 2016

Answer:

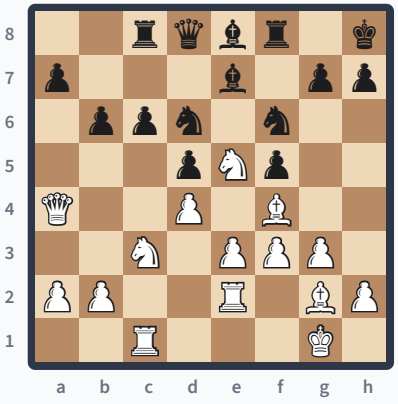
4 **White to move. Can you take on d5?**



Gusev v Bronstein
Moscow-ch 1947

Answer:

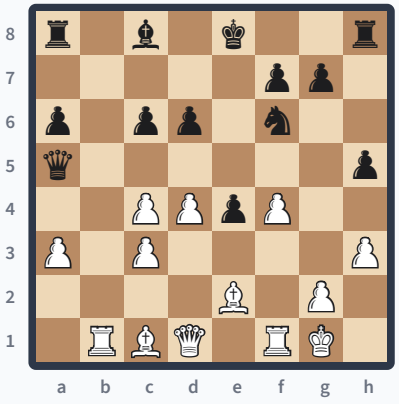
5 **White to move. Can you take on a7?**



Vachier Lagrave v Caruana
FIDE World Cup 2013

Answer:

6 **Black to move. Can you take on c3?**



Ding v Svidler
Alekhine Mem 2013

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

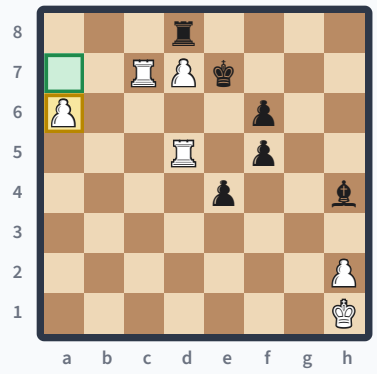
TWO WEAKNESSES

Stretch the defence on both wings

Lesson 21 · Endgame
Level 5 Endgame

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

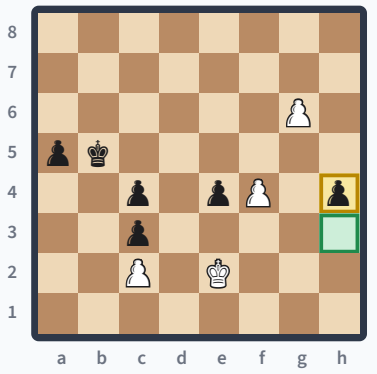


`46.a7 Ke6 47.Rc8`

- One weakness can usually be defended. Two, far apart, cannot.
- Create the second weakness on the opposite wing.
- Jimenez Zerquera v Smyslov, Capablanca mem 1967: **46.a7!** White is winning (engine +8.4).

2. Antoshin–Botvinnik

SECOND FRONT

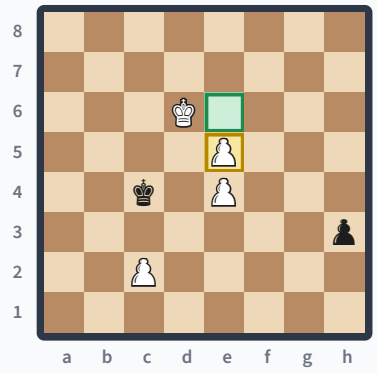


`43...h3 44.g7 h2`

- Black is better and creates a second weakness.
- **43...h3!** 44.g7 h2: Black is clearly better (engine +1.9).
- Antoshin v Botvinnik, URS-ch22 1955

3. Kreisl–Giri: 54.e6!

SECOND FRONT

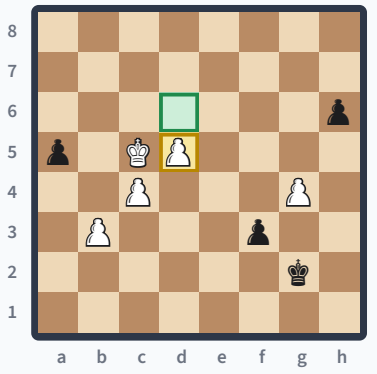


`54.e6 Kb4 55.e7`

- White is better and creates a second weakness.
- **54.e6!** 54...Kb4 55.e7: White is winning (engine +4.3).
- Kreisl v Giri, GM 2008

4. Smyslov–Szilagyi

SECOND FRONT



`52.d6 f2 53.d7`

- White is better and creates a second weakness.
- **52.d6!** 52...f2 53.d7: White is clearly better (engine +2.9).
- Smyslov v Szilagyi, Moscow CCCT 1960

The Principle of Two Weaknesses

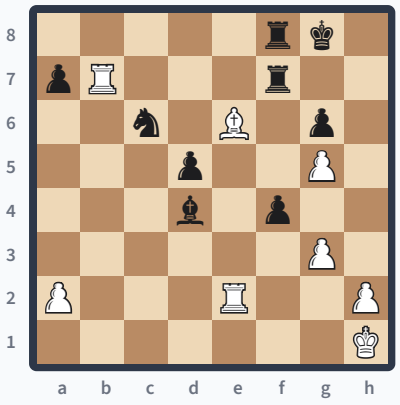
1. Fix the first weakness, then open a second front.
2. The defender's King cannot be on both wings.
3. Then switch quickly between the two targets.

PUZZLES: TWO WEAKNESSES

Six positions from master games

Lesson 21 · Endgame Puzzles
Level 5 Endgame

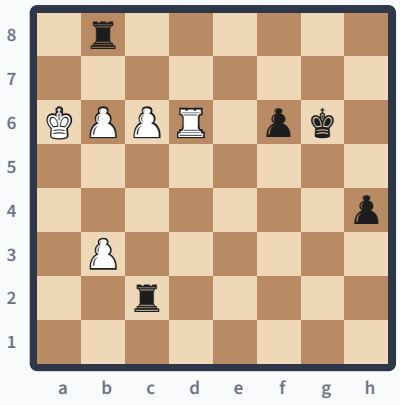
1 **Find the best move for Black!**



Van Wely v Carlsen
77th Tata Steel GpA 2015

Answer:

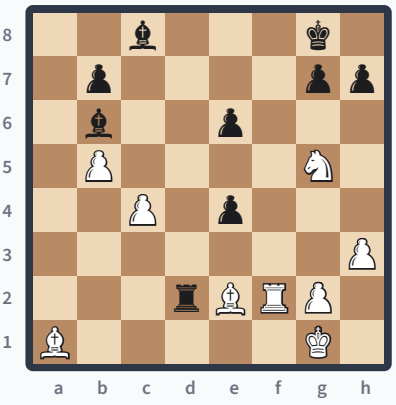
2 **Find the best move for Black!**



Weiqi v Ding
zt 3.5 Men 2009

Answer:

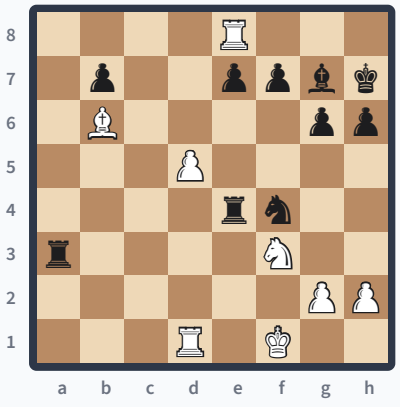
3 **Find the best move for White!**



Grischuk v Navara
Vugar Gashimov Mem 2019

Answer:

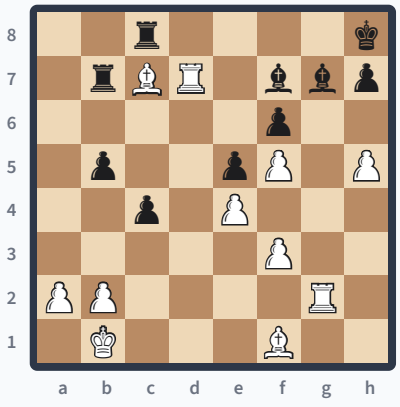
4 **Find the best move for Black!**



Korchnoi v Smirin
GM 2002

Answer:

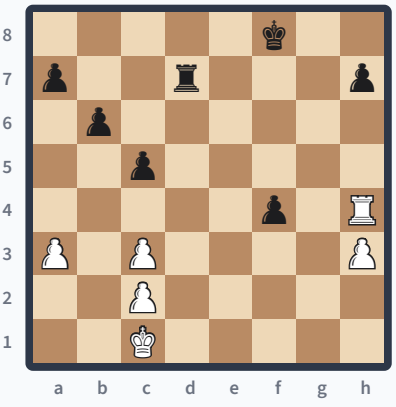
5 **Find the best move for White!**



Larsen v Lombardy
WchT U26 1957

Answer:

6 **Find the best move for Black!**



Marshall v Lasker
USA-ch m 1923

Answer:

Tip: convert step by step: stop counterplay, trade pieces, then push the passed pawn.

Score: ____ / 6

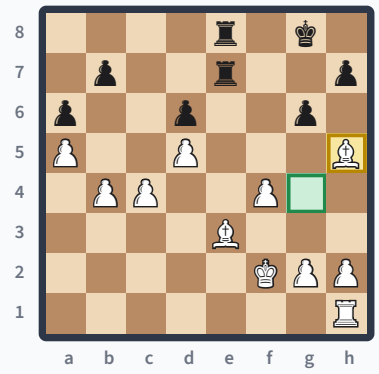
DON'T HURRY

The patient technique of Capablanca and Karpov

Lesson 22 · Endgame
Level 5 Endgame

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

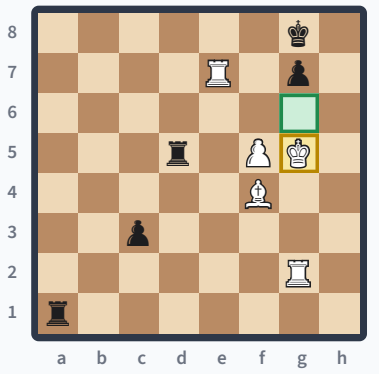


`30.Bg4 Rxe3 31.Be6+`

- When the opponent has no counterplay, there is no need to hurry: improve every piece first.
- Shereshevsky's rule: "Do not hurry" — repeat moves if needed to gain time on the clock.
- Anand v Pacheco, Wch U20 1986: **30.Bg4!** White is winning (engine +3.6).

2. Bronstein–Gligoric

NO HURRY

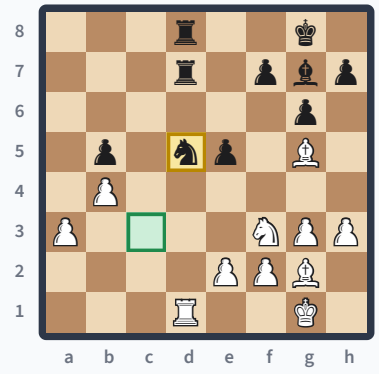


`53.Kg6 Ra6+ 54.Re6`

- White improves the position first.
- **53.Kg6!** 53...Ra6+ 54.Re6: White is winning (engine +5.1).
- Bronstein v Gligoric, Belgrade 1954

3. Raizman–Euwe

NO HURRY

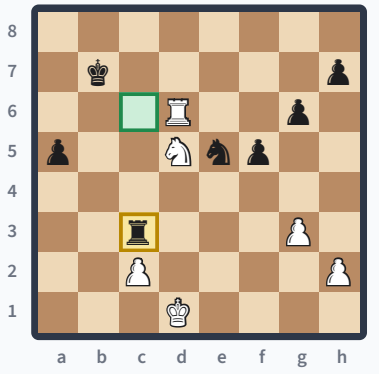


`22...Nc3 23.Rd2 f6`

- Black improves the position first.
- **22...Nc3!** 23.Rd2 f6: Black is winning (engine +4.4).
- Raizman v Euwe, Munich olm prel 1958

4. Savon–Keres: 58...Rc6!

NO HURRY



`58...Rc6 59.Rd8 Rc8`

- Black improves the position first.
- **58...Rc6!** 59.Rd8 Rc8: Black is clearly better (engine +2.4).
- Savon v Keres, URS-ch29 1961

Patience Wins

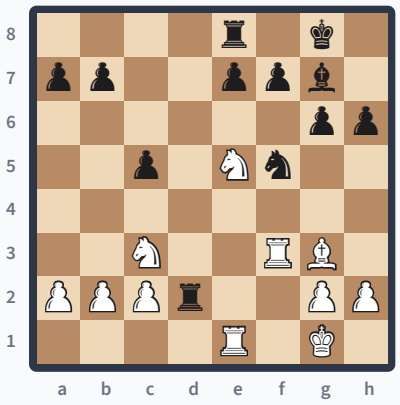
1. Improve the King, then the worst piece, then the pawns.
2. Only change the structure when everything is ready.
3. A rushed pawn move can never be taken back.

PUZZLES: DON'T HURRY

Six positions from master games

Lesson 22 · Endgame Puzzles
Level 5 Endgame

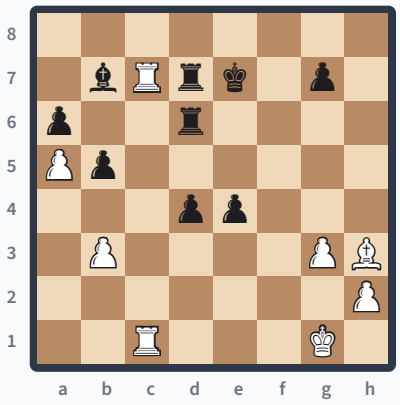
1 Find the best move for White!



Larsen v Stein
Sousse Interzonal 1967

Answer:

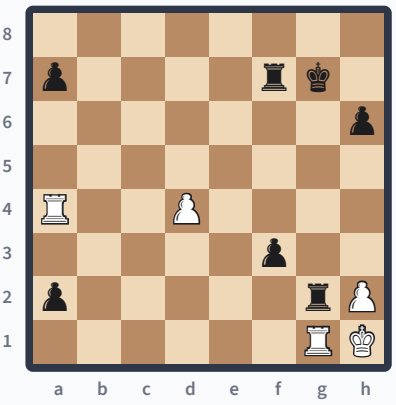
2 Find the best move for Black!



Golmayo Zupide v Steinitz
Habana m 1883

Answer:

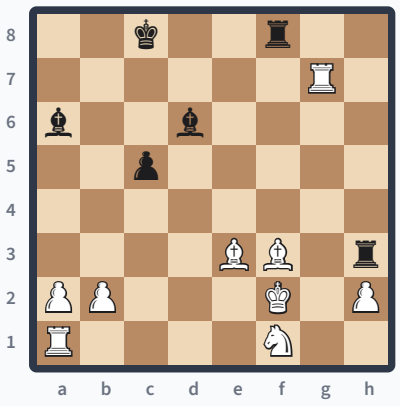
3 Find the best move for Black!



Topalov v Bareev
GMA 2004

Answer:

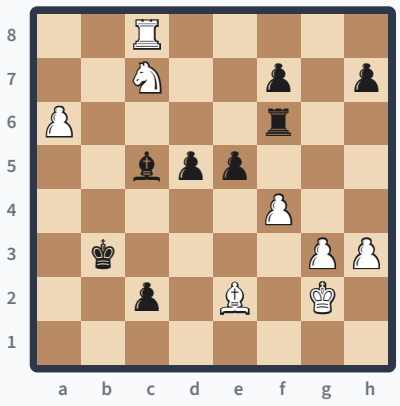
4 Find the best move for White!



So v Aronian
77th Tata Steel GpA 2015

Answer:

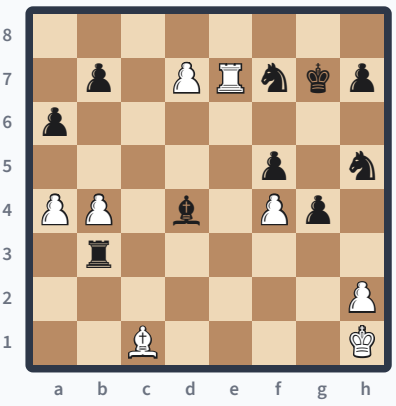
5 Find the best move for White!



Kortschnoj v Greenfeld
Beersheba m 1995

Answer:

6 Find the best move for Black!



Pollmacher v Anderssen
Leipzig m 1855

Answer:

Tip: convert step by step: stop counterplay, trade pieces, then push the passed pawn.

Score: ____ / 6

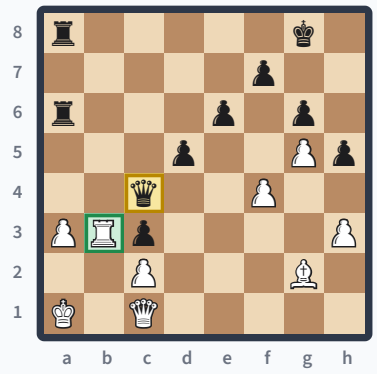
GIVE IT BACK

Return some material to keep the win

Lesson 23 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

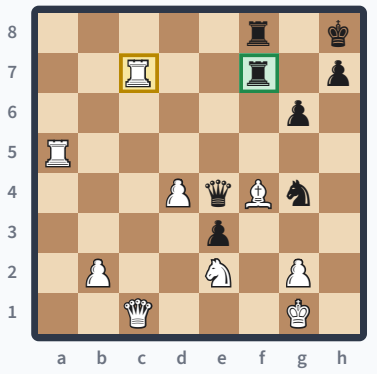


`38...Qxb3 39.cxb3 Rxa3+`

- Extra material is useless if the opponent has a strong attack or passed pawn.
- Returning part of it to kill the counterplay is often the cleanest win.
- Yates v Capablanca, Moscow 1925: **38...Qxb3!** (winning 1 point).

2. Ding–Efimenko

GIVE IT BACK

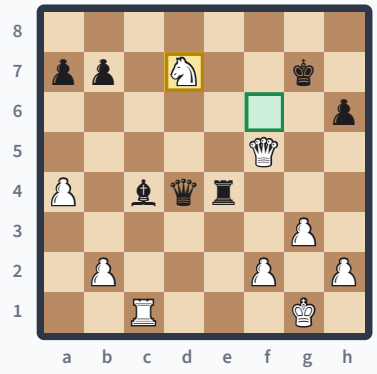


`40.Rxf7 Rxf7 41.Qc8+`

- White is ahead and gives some material back.
- **40.Rxf7!** 40...Rxf7 41.Qc8+: White is winning (engine +7.2).
- Ding v Efimenko, 34th ECC Open 2018

3. Navara–Svidler

GIVE IT BACK

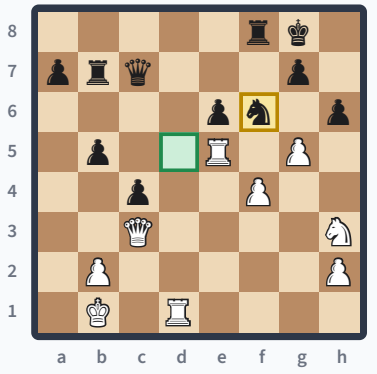


`39.Nf6 Re7 40.Nh5+`

- White is ahead and gives some material back.
- **39.Nf6!** 39...Re7 40.Nh5+: White is winning (engine +5.4).
- Navara v Svidler, 37th Olympiad 2006

4. Bronstein–Botvinnik

GIVE IT BACK



`24...Nd5 25.Rdxd5 exd5`

- Black is ahead and gives some material back.
- **24...Nd5!** 25.Rdxd5 exd5, winning 1 point.
- Bronstein v Botvinnik, World Championship 19th 1951

Giving Back

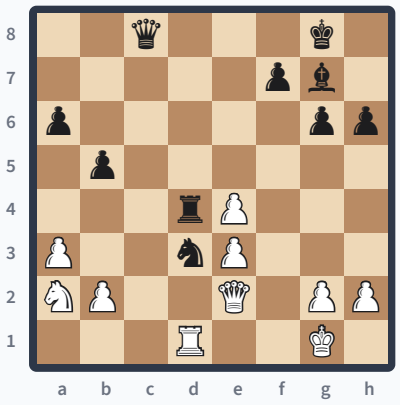
1. Ask: what is the opponent's only trump? Can I remove it by returning material?
2. Give back the exchange or a pawn to reach a simple won endgame.
3. Count: you must still be clearly ahead afterwards.

PUZZLES: GIVE IT BACK

Six positions from master games

Lesson 23 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

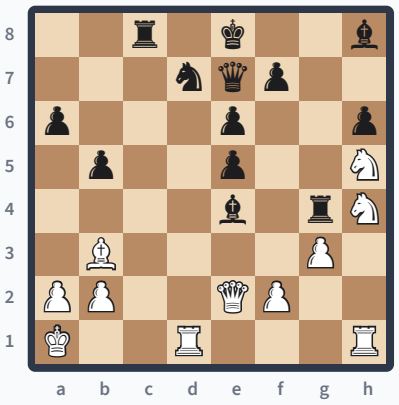
1 **Black is ahead. Find the best move!**



Gruenfeld v Alekhine
Karlsbad 1923

Answer:

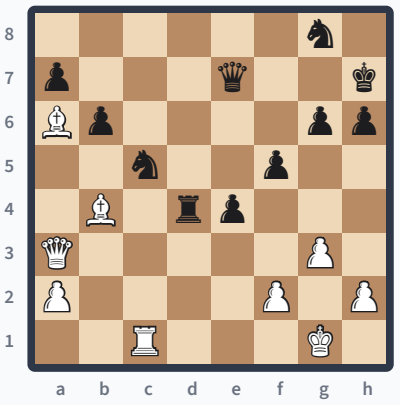
2 **Black is ahead. Find the best move!**



Papaioannou v Mamedyarov
18th European Teams 2011

Answer:

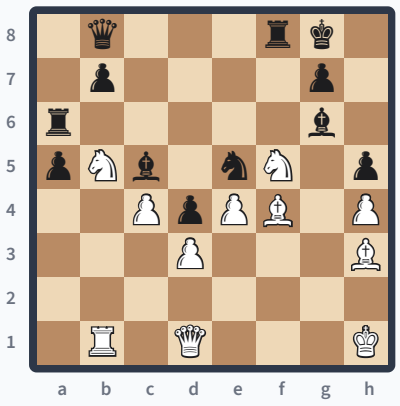
3 **Black is ahead. Find the best move!**



Weenink v Euwe
Amsterdam 1925

Answer:

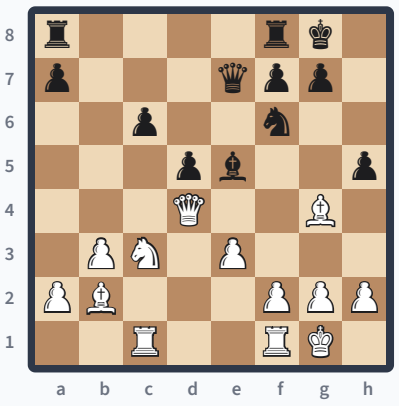
4 **Black is ahead. Find the best move!**



Bilek v Kortschnoj
EU-chT 1973

Answer:

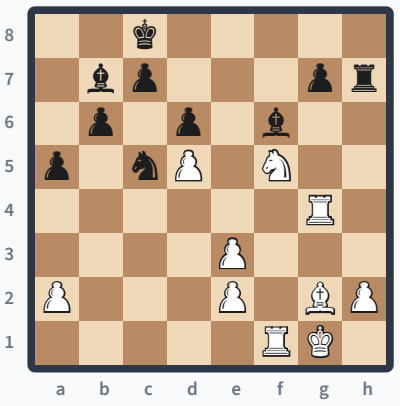
5 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Smyslov v Govbinder
URS-chT 1967

Answer:

6 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Gelfand v Morozevich
WCh 2007

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

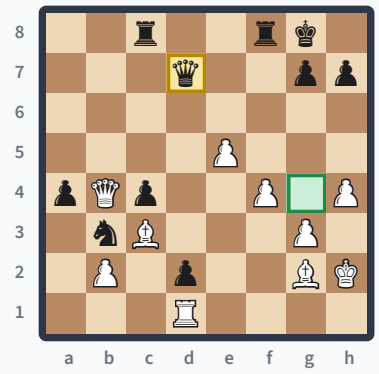
CONVERTING THE EXCHANGE

Rook against minor piece: how to win

Lesson 24 · Strategy
Level 5 Strategy

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

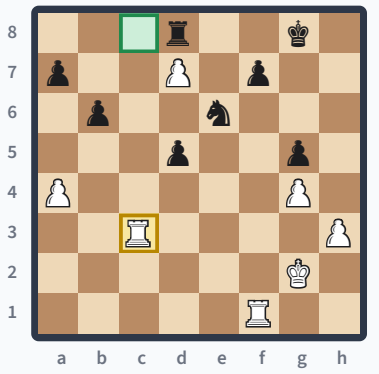


`28...Qg4 29.Rxd2 Nxd2`

- The Rook needs open files: open them, even at the cost of a pawn.
- Trade the opponent's active pieces; the lone minor piece gets weaker.
- Polgar v Gelfand, World Cup 2009: **28...Qg4!** (winning 1 point).

2. Kortschnoj–Kolarov

EXCHANGE UP

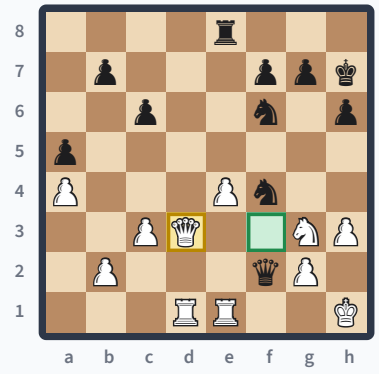


`45.Rc8 Kg7 46.Rxd8`

- White is the exchange up.
- **45.Rc8!** 45...Kg7 46.Rxd8: White is winning (engine +4.9).
- Kortschnoj v Kolarov, Bucharest 1966

3. Carlsen–Adams: 31.Qf3!

EXCHANGE UP

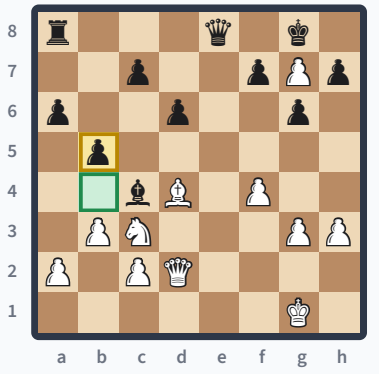


`31.Qf3 Nxh3 32.Kh2`

- White is the exchange up.
- **31.Qf3!** 31...Nxh3 32.Kh2: White is clearly better (engine +1.7).
- Carlsen v Adams, 78th Tata Steel GpA 2016

4. Geller–Henris

EXCHANGE UP



`19...b4 20.Nd1 Bd5`

- Black is the exchange up.
- **19...b4!** 20.Nd1 Bd5: Black is winning (engine +4.1).
- Geller v Henris, Cappelle op 1993

Winning With the Exchange

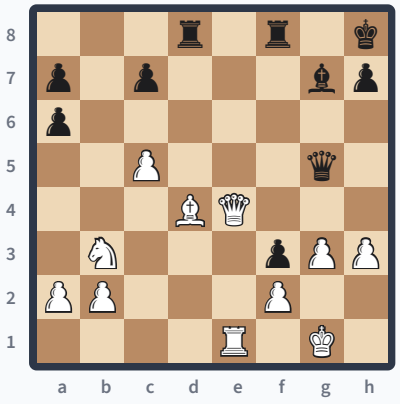
1. Open files for the Rook and invade on the 7th rank.
2. Give back the exchange if it reaches a won endgame.
3. Avoid blockades where the minor piece is as good as a Rook.

PUZZLES: CONVERTING THE EXCHANGE

Six positions from master games

Lesson 24 · Strategy Puzzles
Level 5 Strategy

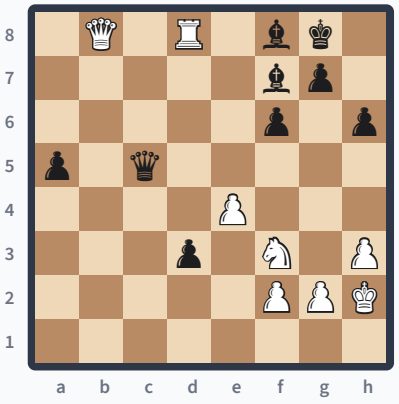
1 Find the best move for Black!



Van Wely v Gelfand
EU-ch U20 1988

Answer:

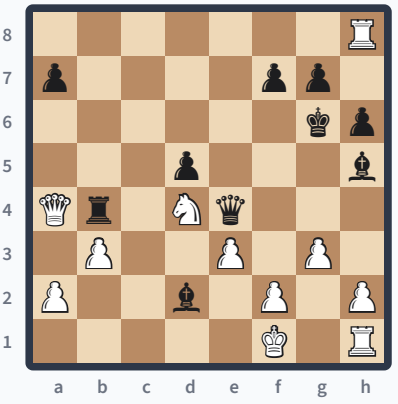
2 Find the best move for White!



Grischuk v Pengxiang
World Team Ch 2005

Answer:

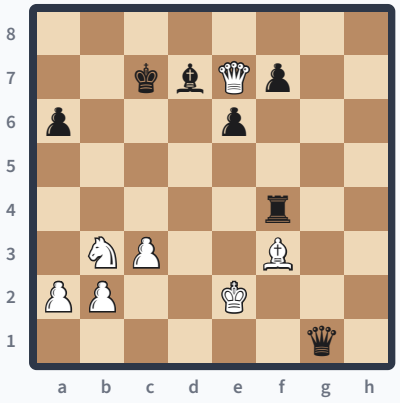
3 Find the best move for White!



Ivanchuk v Lupulescu
20th European Teams 2015

Answer:

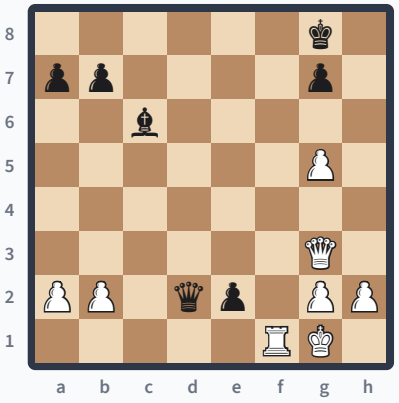
4 Find the best move for Black!



Kotronias v Kramnik
Chalkidiki 1992

Answer:

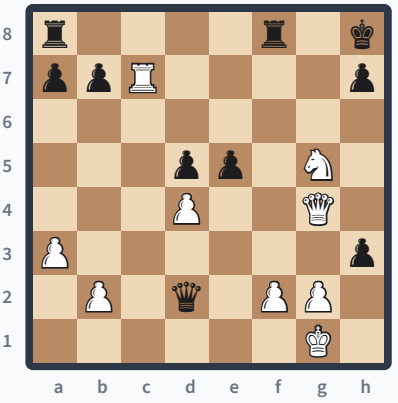
5 Find the best move for White!



Rubinstein v Johner
Karlsbad 1911

Answer:

6 Find the best move for Black!



Taimanov v Larsen
Vinkovci 1970

Answer:

Tip: first find the plan for this structure, then check the tactics that serve it.

Score: ____ / 6

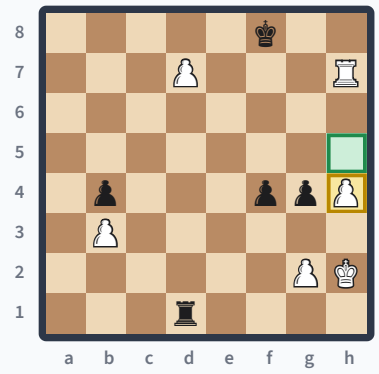
ROOK ENDGAME: PAWN UP

Half are drawn: technique decides

Lesson 25 · Endgame
Level 5 Endgame

1. By the Numbers

MASTER GAMES

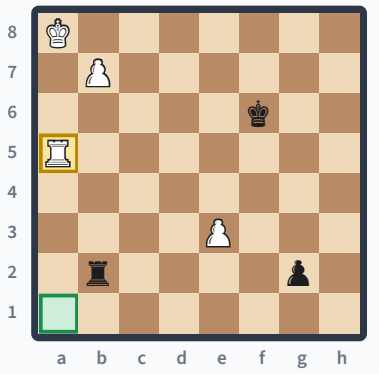


`54.h5 Kg8 55.Re7`

- **Win rate with a pawn up in a rook endgame: 47%/49%/5%**
- Half are drawn: one extra pawn is often not enough.
- An active Rook matters more than the pawn.
- Leko v Nyback, 20th European Teams 2015: **54.h5!** White is winning (engine +6.7).

2. Smyslov–Jimenez Zerquera

PAWN UP

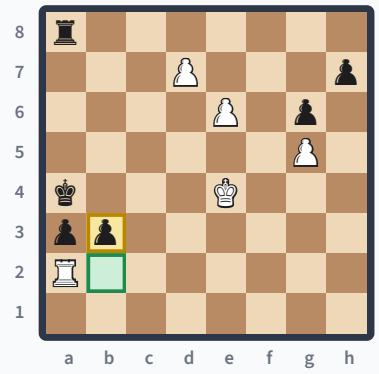


`53.Ra1 Ke5 54.b8=Q+`

- White is a pawn up in a rook endgame.
- **53.Ra1!** 53...Ke5 54.b8=Q+: White is winning (engine +4.5).
- Smyslov v Jimenez Zerquera, Alekhine mem 1963

3. Marshall–Howell

PAWN UP

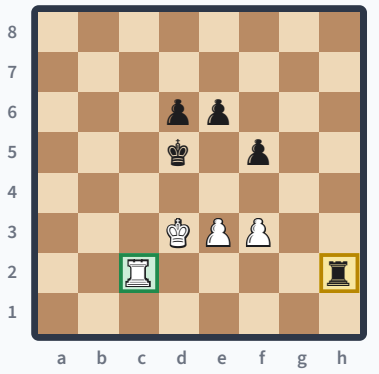


`59...b2 60.e7 b1=Q+`

- Black is a pawn up in a rook endgame.
- **59...b2!** 60.e7 b1=Q+: Black is winning (engine +8.5).
- Marshall v Howell, Buffalo 1901

4. Saemisch–Alekhine

PAWN UP



`49...Rxc2 50.Kxc2 Kc4`

- Black is a pawn up in a rook endgame.
- **49...Rxc2!** 50.Kxc2 Kc4: Black is winning (engine +7.1).
- Saemisch v Alekhine, Dresden 1926

Winning Rook Endgames

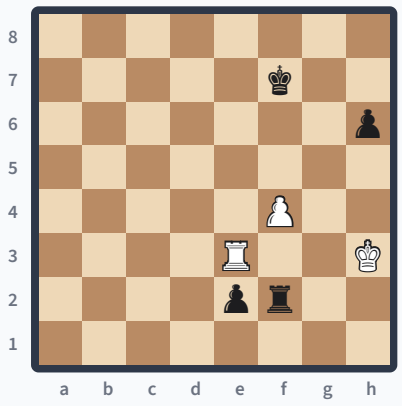
1. Put your Rook behind the passed pawn and keep it active.
2. Cut off the enemy King, then bring yours forward.
3. Keep pawns on both wings: two weaknesses again.

PUZZLES: ROOK ENDGAME: PAWN UP

Six positions from master games

Lesson 25 · Endgame Puzzles
Level 5 Endgame

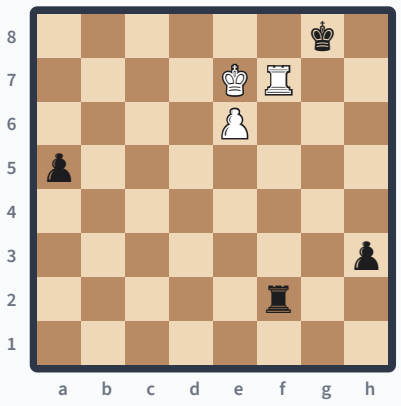
1 Find the best move for Black!



Nakamura v Gelfand
5th NH Chess Tournament 2010

Answer:

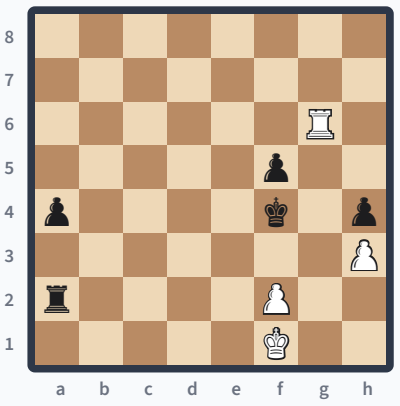
2 Find the best move for Black!



Kovalyov v So
9th Edmonton Int 2014

Answer:

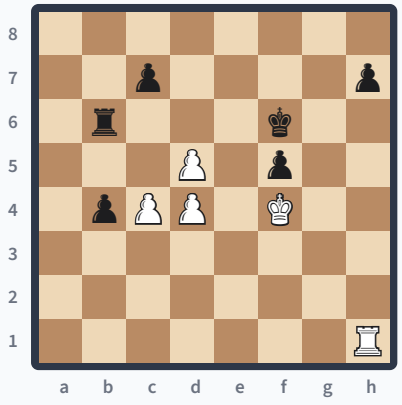
3 Find the best move for Black!



Janowsky v Alekhine
Hastings2627 1926

Answer:

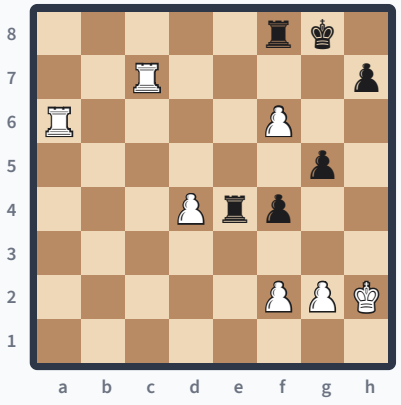
4 Find the best move for Black!



Anderssen v Hirschfeld
Berlin m 1860

Answer:

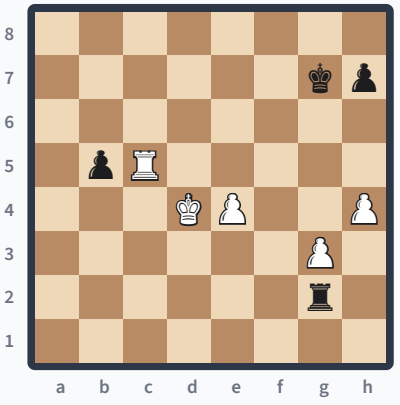
5 Find the best move for White!



Topalov v Leko
XXV SuperGM 2008

Answer:

6 Find the best move for White!



Smyslov v Ivkov
Capablanca mem 1962

Answer:

Tip: convert step by step: stop counterplay, trade pieces, then push the passed pawn.

Score: ____ / 6

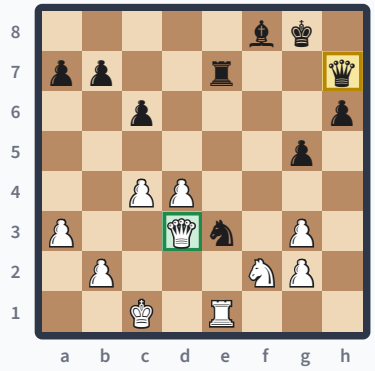
ATTACK, MATERIAL, ENDGAME

The full conversion

Lesson 26 · Endgame
Level 5 Endgame

1. The Technique

TECHNIQUE

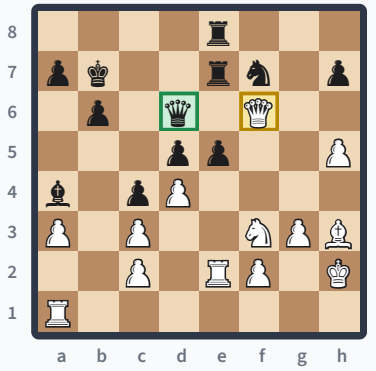


`34...Qxd3 35.Nxd3 Nxc4`

- A successful attack often wins material; the next step is to trade queens and win the endgame.
- Every stage changes the type of advantage: time, then material, then a won endgame.
- Junge v Alekhine, Salzburg 1942: **34...Qxd3!** (winning 1 point).

2. Anand–Lalic: 27.Qxd6!

TRADE QUEENS

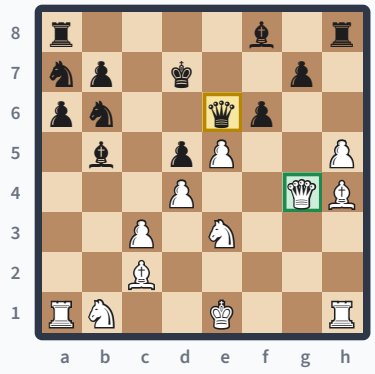


`27.Qxd6 Nxd6 28.Nxe5`

- White is ahead and heads for the endgame.
- **27.Qxd6!** 27...Nxd6 28.Nxe5, winning 1 point.
- Anand v Lalic, Lloyds Bank op 1987

3. Barendregt–Bronstein

TRADE QUEENS

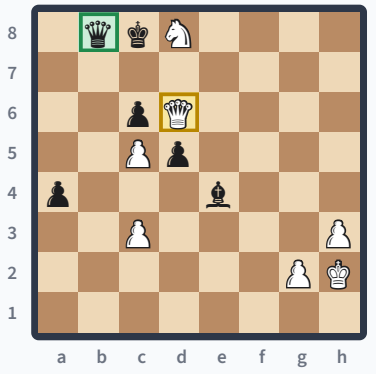


`25...Qxg4 26.Nxg4 Rxh5`

- Black is ahead and heads for the endgame.
- **25...Qxg4!** 26.Nxg4 Rxh5, winning 1 point.
- Barendregt v Bronstein, EU-chT 1965

4. Hamdouchi–Caruana

TRADE QUEENS



`58.Qxb8+ Kxb8 59.Nxc6+`

- White is ahead and heads for the endgame.
- **58.Qxb8+!** 58...Kxb8 59.Nxc6+: White keeps an edge (engine +0.9).
- Hamdouchi v Caruana, VIII Open 2006

The Full Conversion

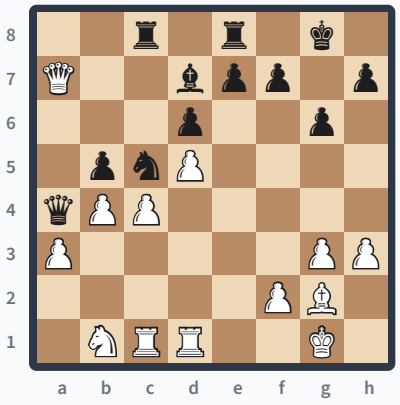
1. Attack while it gains something; then simplify.
2. Trading queens ends the opponent's counterplay against your King.
3. In the endgame: King to the centre, push the passed pawn.

PUZZLES: ATTACK, MATERIAL, ENDGAME

Six positions from master games

Lesson 26 · Endgame Puzzles
Level 5 Endgame

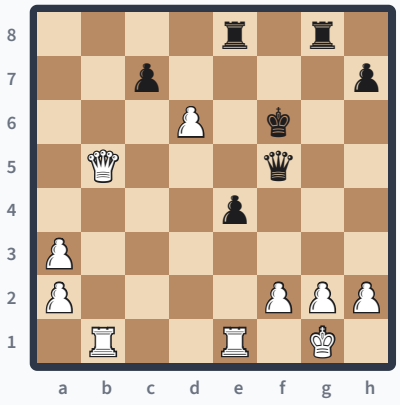
1 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Karpov v Carlsen
GpB 2006

Answer:

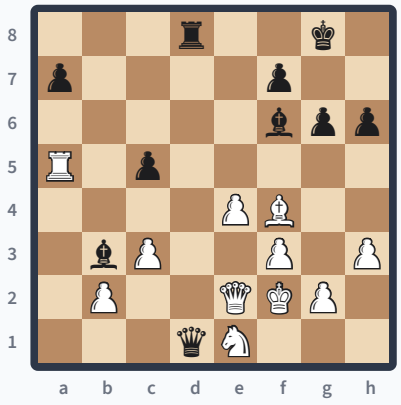
2 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Euwe v Speijer
Amsterdam m2 1921

Answer:

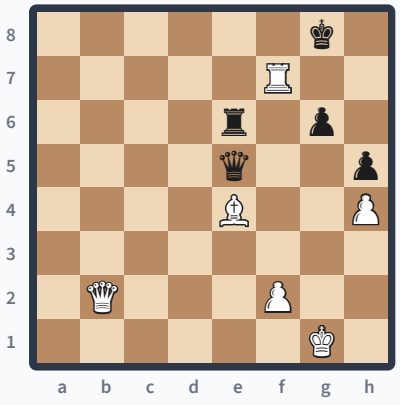
3 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Pavlov v Geller
URS-ch sf 1950

Answer:

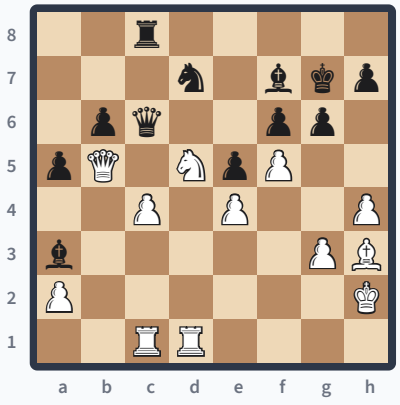
4 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Kortschnoj v Ivkov
URS-JUG 1958

Answer:

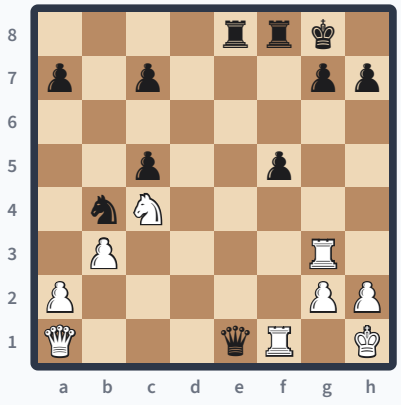
5 **White is ahead. Find the best move!**



Kortschnoj v Moor
Nagler mem 1998

Answer:

6 **Black is ahead. Find the best move!**



Blackburne v Lasker
St Petersburg prel 1914

Answer:

Tip: convert step by step: stop counterplay, trade pieces, then push the passed pawn.

Score: ____ / 6

SOLUTIONS

All puzzle answers · Players and event are printed under each puzzle

No peeking
until you've tried!

1. The Scale of Values p. 2

1 47.Bd1+ Qe2+ 48.Bxe2#, and mate follows
2 35...Qe4+ 36.Qg2 Qxg2+: Black is winning (engine +3.1)
3 42...Bf2 43.Qc3 Re3+: Black is winning (engine +8.7)
4 35...Rf1+ 36.Kh2 Qxe3, winning 5 points
5 26.e6 Nxe3 27.exf7+, winning 5 points
6 22...Ne2+ 23.Kh1 Nxf4, winning 6 points

2. The Bishop Pair p. 4

1 28.c6 bxc6 29.bxc6: White is winning (engine +3.6)
2 35...exf4 36.Rxe8+ Kxe8, winning 1 point
3 24...cxb3 25.Rxc8 bxa2: Black is clearly better (engine +1.5)
4 30...e4 31.dxe4 Rxe4: Black is clearly better (engine +1.8)
5 19.c4 Nd4 20.Qb2: White is clearly better (engine +2.9)
6 25...f4 26.gxf4 g5: Black keeps an edge (engine +0.6)

3. Bishop vs Knight p. 6

1 44.Qe3 c2 45.d7: White is clearly better (engine +2.0)
2 40...c2 41.Rxg1 Bxg1: Black is winning (engine +3.9)
3 38...Bb4 39.Rg1 Qxa2, winning 1 point
4 24.g3 Rc8 25.Qe4: White is winning (engine +4.0)
5 22...Rxg2 23.Qxf6 Rg1+: Black is clearly better (engine +2.9)
6 58.Qf5+ Qg6 59.Rb1: White is winning (engine +4.0)

4. The Exchange p. 8

1 26...Qxf2+ 27.Kh2 Rf7, winning 1 point
2 39.Qxh5 Qf6 40.Bf5, winning 1 point
3 24...Qd7 25.Qb3 Rb8: Black is winning (engine +3.2)
4 16...Nxf3+ 17.Ke2 Nd4+, winning 1 point
5 26.Kg2 Bxe3 27.g5: the only move to hold the balance
6 25.Be3 Bc6 26.Qc7: White keeps an edge (engine +0.8)

5. Imbalances p. 10

1 40.Qg3 g6 41.Qg4: White is winning (engine +4.2)
2 35.Rag1 Be8 36.Rg8: White is winning (engine +3.8)
3 46.f7 b2 47.Qf5: White is winning (engine +3.2)
4 25...Qxg5 26.Qxg5 Nxg5, winning 1 point
5 37.Re8+ Kh7 38.Bd4+: White is winning (engine +4.6)
6 34.h4 Bc6 35.h5: White is winning (engine +4.1)

6. Time: Worth a Pawn? p. 12

1 15...h6 16.Ne4 Qd7: Black is clearly better (engine +1.4)
2 11.d6 h6 12.Be3: White is clearly better (engine +1.5)
3 16.d5 Qd8 17.d6: White is winning (engine +3.6)
4 12...h6 13.Bxf6 Nxf6: Black keeps an edge (engine +0.5)
5 12.exd6 Bxd6 13.Nxd6+: White keeps an edge (engine +0.8)
6 16.gxh6+ Rxh6 17.Rf7+: White keeps an edge (engine +0.7)

7. Space p. 14

1 28...exf3 29.gxf3 hxg4, winning 1 point
2 27...e3 28.Re2 Rg5: Black is clearly better (engine +2.4)
3 32.f6 Bxf6 33.Rxf6, winning 1 point
4 19.f6 O-O 20.Rd4: White is winning (engine +3.1)
5 26.f6 Nxf6 27.gxf6, winning 1 point
6 24...e3 25.Qf3 Qxf3: Black is winning (engine +3.7)

8. Doubled Pawns p. 16

1 25.Qd8+ Kh7 26.Qh4+: White is winning (engine +3.4)
2 25...Qd1+ 26.Bf1 Qd8: Black is winning (engine +4.1)
3 22.Nxd7 Qxd7 23.Bf2: White is clearly better (engine +1.7)
4 19.Bf4 Qe4 20.f3: White is winning (engine +4.8)
5 34.fxe5 Nf5 35.Rd8, winning 1 point
6 37.Nd3 Bd4 38.Kb1: White is winning (engine +3.9)

9. Isolated and Backward Pawns p. 18

1 13.Qxf4 Nxc2+ 14.Kd1: White is clearly better (engine +2.9)
2 31...cxd5 32.Qxd5 Qe6: Black is clearly better (engine +1.4)
3 44.bxc7+ Qxc7 45.g7: White is winning (engine +4.8)
4 25.bxc5 Rxc5 26.Qb3: White is clearly better (engine +2.3)
5 29.Qxb6 Ne6 30.Qe3, winning 1 point
6 33.Qxa7 Qxb2 34.a4: White is winning (engine +3.5)

10. Passed Pawns p. 20

1 28...d2 29.Qc3 b4: Black is clearly better (engine +1.3)
2 25.d7 Rc7 26.Rbd1: White is winning (engine +4.4)
3 56.f6+ Kxh7 57.f7: White is clearly better (engine +2.8)
4 38.c7 Rxb5 39.Rf8+: White is clearly better (engine +2.5)
5 24.d7 Rd8 25.Qh4: White is clearly better (engine +1.4)
6 29...d2 30.Nxd8 Qxf1+: Black is winning (engine +4.3)

11. King Safety p. 22

1 32.Qe8+ Qe7 33.Qxe7#, and mate follows
2 35.Rd6+ Ke5 36.Qxg7+, winning 4 points
3 28.Qe7+ Qf7 29.Re1: White is winning (engine +4.2)
4 60.Rb8+ Rc8 61.Qxe6: White is winning (engine +3.1)
5 39...Rf7 40.Qc8 Qxc3, winning 1 point
6 36.Rd8+ Kg7 37.Qxf7+: White is winning (engine +7.2)

12. Piece Activity p. 24

1 26.Ne5 Nd8 27.Qd6: White is clearly better (engine +2.5)
2 41.Rh2 Kg8 42.Qh6: White is winning (engine +4.1)
3 32.Nc6 Rf7 33.Re3: White is winning (engine +3.2)
4 42.Rba1 Rd6 43.Ra8: White is winning (engine +3.8)
5 24...Re8 25.g3 Qe5: Black keeps an edge (engine +0.7)
6 38...Rb2 39.Rxg3 Qc1: Black is winning (engine +3.6)

13. Static vs Dynamic p. 26

1 22.Bd3 Bxd3 23.Qxd3: White is clearly better (engine +1.0)
2 29.Nh4 Qd8 30.Ng6: White is clearly better (engine +2.5)
3 14...Qa5 15.Rb1 Qxc3: Black is clearly better (engine +1.5)
4 19.Bd6 Qg5 20.c5: White is clearly better (engine +2.2)
5 31...h6 32.fxe5 Nxe5: Black is winning (engine +4.2)
6 40...Nd3 41.Rxg4 Qxg4: Black is clearly better (engine +1.6)

14. Use It or Lose It p. 28

1 12.e4 Nxe4 13.Nxe4: White is clearly better (engine +1.0)
2 9.exd6 Qxd6 10.Qf3: White is clearly better (engine +1.3)
3 12...dxc4 13.Qxd8+ Rxd8, winning 1 point
4 16.Nxc6 Rxd2 17.Bxc5, winning 1 point
5 15...f5 16.exf5 Bxf5: Black keeps an edge (engine +0.8)
6 13.d5 Bg4 14.Rd2: White is clearly better (engine +2.3)

15. Extra Material: Trade Pieces p. 30

1 49.Bxe6+ Kxe6 50.h7: White is clearly better (engine +3.0)
2 44.Rxh8 Kxh8 45.Ng2: White is winning (engine +4.5)
3 31.Qxc5 Qxe4 32.Qd5+: White is winning (engine +3.1)
4 39.dxc5 Qc6 40.h4, winning 1 point
5 26...Rxe1+ 27.Rxe1 Qxb3, winning 1 point
6 31...Rxe4 32.Qxd8 Rxd8: Black is winning (engine +4.5)

16. First Stop the Counterplay p. 32

1 25...Qa4 26.Nf2 Qd4: Black is winning (engine +3.7)
2 67...e4 68.Qb2 Qc5: Black is winning (engine +5.7)
3 39.c6 Kg7 40.c7: White is winning (engine +5.0)
4 58.Rc7 Bd3 59.a4: White is winning (engine +7.0)
5 39.a3 Nd7 40.Qd1: White is winning (engine +4.1)
6 18...Nd4 19.Qxc7 Nxe2+: Black is clearly better (engine +1.1)

17. From Time to Attack p. 34

1 29.Rxd8 Be3 30.Qf8+, winning 5 points
2 42...Qh3+ 43.Qh2 Qxh2#, and mate follows
3 20...Ne5 21.Rc3 Qf3: Black is winning (engine +5.9)
4 48...Qg3 49.Qe1 Qf4, and mate follows
5 36.h6 Qc1+ 37.Kh2: White is winning (engine +9.9)
6 22...Qa1+ 23.Qb1 Rxb1+, and mate follows

18. Space: Squeeze, Then Break p. 36

1 20.d6+ e6 21.Qc6: White is clearly better (engine +1.1)
2 22.fxg6 hxg6 23.Ne6: White is clearly better (engine +2.9)
3 25.cxd6 cxd6 26.f4: White keeps an edge (engine +0.6)
4 26.b5 cxb5 27.Bxb5: White is clearly better (engine +1.3)
5 22.e6 Bb7 23.exf7+: White is clearly better (engine +2.4)
6 18.h5 a5 19.hxg6: White is winning (engine +3.9)

19. Better Structure: Choose the Endgame p. 38

1 23.Qxb6 Rxb6 24.Rxe5, winning 1 point
2 35...Qxe2 36.Rxe2 Rxe4, winning 1 point
3 12.Qxd8 Rxd8 13.Rfd1: White is clearly better (engine +1.7)
4 21.Qxb4 axb4 22.Nd6: White is winning (engine +3.8)
5 32.Qxe8+ Rxe8 33.Rxh2, winning 1 point
6 16...Qxb4 17.Bxb4 Nb6: Black is clearly better (engine +1.2)

20. The Poisoned Pawn p. 40

1 19.Ng3 Bc8 20.Rhf1. Not 19.Qxb7? 19...Bxe4 20.Bxe4 (engine -5.5)
2 16.Nf5 Qd8 17.Qxd5. Not 16.Qxd5? 16...Qxe3+ 17.Kh1 (engine -5.4)
3 26...Rb8 27.Qe2 Qc6. Not 26...Qxh3? 27.Qxd6 Raa8 (engine -2.2)
4 15.Bh2 Qd8 16.a5. Not 15.Qxd5? 15...Nxf4 16.Qc4 (engine -5.7)
5 23.Qc2 Nh5 24.Nd3. Not 23.Qxa7? 23...Ra8 24.Qxa8 (engine -6.0)
6 15...Bf5 16.Be3 Qxa3. Not 15...Qxc3? 16.Rb3 Qa5 (engine -2.0)

21. Two Weaknesses p. 42

1 33...f3 34.Rc2 f2: Black is winning (engine +3.1)
2 48...h3 49.c7 Ra8+: Black is clearly better (engine +2.5)
3 23.c5 Bxc5 24.Nxe4: White is winning (engine +3.4)
4 32...f5 33.Bc7 Rd3: Black is clearly better (engine +2.8)
5 30.h6 Rbxc7 31.Rxc7: White is winning (engine +3.6)
6 41...f3 42.Rf4+ Rf7: Black is winning (engine +6.0)

22. Don't Hurry p. 44

1 22.Rf2 Rxf2 23.Bxf2: White is clearly better (engine +2.4)
2 38...Bd5 39.Rxd7+ Rxd7: Black is clearly better (engine +1.4)
3 47...Kf8 48.Rc1 Rb2: Black is winning (engine +7.1)
4 42.Nd2 Rxh2+ 43.Kg1: White is winning (engine +4.4)
5 40.Ne6 Rxe6 41.Rxc5: White is clearly better (engine +1.1)
6 41...Rb1 42.Re1 Nxf4, winning 1 point

23. Giving Material Back p. 46

1 31...Nf4 32.exf4 Qc4: Black is winning (engine +5.1)
2 25...Bxh1 26.Qxg4 Qg5: Black is winning (engine +3.8)
3 28...Rxb4 29.Qxb4 Nxa6, winning 1 point
4 30...Nxd3 31.Bxb8 Nf2+: Black is winning (engine +4.9)
5 16.Nxd5 cxd5 17.Qxe5: White is winning (engine +4.0)
6 28.Nxg7 Rxg7 29.Bh3: White is winning (engine +3.0)

24. Converting the Exchange p. 48

1 25...Bxd4 26.Nxd4 Qd5: Black is winning (engine +3.5)
2 40.e5 a4 41.Qd6: White is winning (engine +3.2)
3 34.Qc6+ f6 35.Qe8+: White is winning (engine +4.4)
4 34...Qb6 35.Nd2 Qd6: Black is winning (engine +4.4)
5 28.Re1 Bb5 29.g6: White is winning (engine +4.7)
6 26...Qxf2+ 27.Kh2 Qxg2+, winning 1 point

25. The Extra Pawn in a Rook Endgame p. 50

1 58...Rf3+ 59.Rxf3 e1=Q: Black is winning (engine +4.5)
2 55...h2 56.Rxf2 h1=Q: Black is winning (engine +4.2)
3 45...Kf3 46.Kg1 Rxf2, winning 1 point
4 40...b3 41.c5 Rb4: Black is winning (engine +3.7)
5 42.Rg7+ Kh8 43.Re7: White is winning (engine +6.4)
6 48.Rxb5 h6 49.Rb3, winning 1 point

26. From Attack to Endgame p. 52

1 24.Qxa4 Nxa4 25.cxb5, winning 1 point
2 33.Qxf5+ Kxf5 34.dxc7, winning 1 point
3 30.Qxd1 Rxd1 31.Rxc5, winning 1 point
4 46.Qxe5 Rxe5 47.Bxg6, winning 1 point
5 33.Qxc6 Rxc6 34.fxg6, winning 1 point
6 31...Qxa1 32.Rxa1 g6: Black is winning (engine +3.5)